

DELHI GOVT STEPS UP ILLEGAL LIQUOR
CRACKDOWN, 725 FIRS, 730 ARRESTS **P3**



RAHUL, MALAYSIAN PM
MEET OVER BREAKFAST **P5**

ALIA SHARED ABOUT
PRODUCING 'DON'T BE SHY' **P12**



BACKS RESILIENCE AMID GEOPOLITICAL UNCERTAINTIES

PM Modi warns against 'weaponisation' of tech, critical minerals at BRICS Summit

VINAY KUMAR
New Delhi, September 13

Prime Minister Narendra Modi on Sunday asked leaders of the BRICS grouping to recognise the dangers of weaponising "technology and critical minerals," which could undo all the gains the world has achieved so far on shared progress and prosperity. No crisis remains contained within a region these days, he said.

With Chinese President Xi Jinping in attendance on the second day of the BRICS Summit, PM Modi pointed out that a large number of geopolitical tensions erupting across the world are affecting all nations without exception.

"The world is witnessing increasing tensions, having a significant negative impact on the lives of ordinary people. Pandemics, climate disasters and supply chain disruptions have demonstrated that in today's interconnected world, no crisis



Prime Minister Narendra Modi with Russian President Vladimir Putin and Chinese President Xi Jinping on the sidelines of the 18th BRICS Summit

remains confined to a single region," he said.

Though PM Modi did not point out specific examples, the comments come amid global energy supply disruptions due to the US-Iran war which has paralysed the critical

shipping lane, Strait of Hormuz.

In his address at the concluding session of the summit, he flagged concerns over rising global conflicts and urged the bloc to work together to mitigate their far-reaching

impact on ordinary lives.

Modi added that developing nations in the Global South increasingly trust BRICS because their voices are heard, their experiences are valued and solutions are created in partnership with them,

HIGHLIGHTS

- » Modi says no crisis remains regionally contained
- » Flags rising global conflicts and tensions
- » Says pandemics exposed vulnerabilities in an interconnected world
- » Urges BRICS to mitigate global crises
- » Technology adoption must remain inclusive, Modi says
- » India's BRICS chairship focused on four pillars

FOUR PILLARS:
RESILIENCE,
INNOVATION,
COOPERATION,
SUSTAINABILITY

rather than imposed on them.

Delving into pressing challenges facing the world, Modi said the "weaponisation of technology and critical minerals can hinder our shared progress. Therefore, we have emphasised inclusivity in the adoption of technology."

China to host 2027 BRICS Summit; Modi extends wishes to Xi

MPOST BUREAU
New Delhi, September 13

Prime Minister Narendra Modi on Sunday extended his best wishes to Chinese President Xi Jinping as the BRICS chairship passes to China, saying the grouping's entry into its third decade has heightened expectations for "concrete results".

Addressing the open session on the concluding day of the BRICS Summit in New Delhi, Modi said the world was now looking to the grouping for outcomes rather than just ideas and commitments.

"BRICS is poised to enter its third decade."

CONTINUED ON P4

Xi proposes five-point BRICS initiative, rejects 'might makes right' logic

Calls for stronger BRICS role

SIMONTINI BHATTACHARJEE
NEW DELHI, September 13

Chinese President Xi Jinping on Sunday called on BRICS countries to strengthen unity among the Global South and play an active, stabilising and positive role in global affairs, while proposing five initiatives on greater BRICS cooperation.

He called for the realignment of the global order and for the Global South to become a key driver of the world's multipolarity. His proposed five initiatives aim to "cement the foundation of greater BRICS cooperation," including extending support in developing and implementing artificial intelligence models.

"The Global South, with its collective rise, has become a key driver of world multipolarity. At the same time, the international landscape is volatile and fraught with risks and challenges. To bring stability to the world and make it a better place, BRICS countries must seize the



JINPING'S FIVE-POINT INITIATIVE:

- » Establish a BRICS AI open-source community
- » Create a BRICS special economic zone partnership
- » Establish a BRICS digital ecosystem cloud platform
- » Build smart factories and develop common standards
- » Create an engineer alliance and youth exchange programme

historical initiative, rally the Global South, be an active, stabilising, and positive force in international affairs, and advance the well-being of all humanity," he said.

WATERBOUND LIVES



A woman rows a traditional country boat while a man gathers lotus leaves from Vellayani Lake, in Thiruvananthapuram, on Sunday

Briefs

Manipur: Militants gun down four

SENIOR IMPHAL:

Four people, including two women, were killed in separate suspected militant attacks in Manipur's Tamenglong and Noney districts on Sunday, police said. Two people were killed at Tollen Kuki village around 4 am, while a woman and a man were shot dead at Longpi village around 3:30 pm. Chief Minister Y Khemchand Singh condemned the killings. The attacks coincided with the Kuki community's annual "Sahnit Ni" observance, held on September 13 to remember victims of 1990s Kuki-Naga violence.

SEE P6

India condemns Oman tanker attack, 13 seafarers rescued

NEW DELHI: India on Sunday condemned an attack on Panama-flagged oil tanker MT El Gaia off Oman that left one Indian seafarer missing, with 13 others rescued.

The Ministry of External Affairs said 14 Indian crew members were aboard the vessel when it was attacked. "Of the 14 Indian crew onboard, 13 Indians have been rescued so far," it said. Search and rescue efforts for the missing seafarer are continuing, while the Indian embassy in Oman is coordinating with Omani authorities. India also thanked Oman for

CONTINUED ON P4

Modi, Xi extend offer to help broker Ukraine peace: Russia

Trump's efforts to broker peace have not produced breakthrough

MPOST BUREAU
New Delhi, September 13

Russia on Sunday said Prime Minister Narendra Modi and Chinese President Xi Jinping offered to help facilitate peace talks to end the Ukraine war during meetings on the sidelines of the BRICS Summit in New Delhi, with Moscow saying President Vladimir Putin welcomed their willingness to assist.

Kremlin spokesperson Dmitry Peskov said Modi and Xi had shown a keen interest in efforts to resolve the conflict and offered their "good offices" to help find a solution. The development comes as US President Donald Trump's efforts to broker a settlement between Russia and Ukraine have yet to produce a breakthrough.

Modi also held a bilateral meeting with Putin during the summit, their second meeting in less than two weeks after they met at the Shanghai Cooperation Organisation summit in Bishkek on August 31.



“MODI AND XI HAD SHOWN A KEEN INTEREST IN EFFORTS TO RESOLVE THE CONFLICT AND OFFERED THEIR ‘GOOD OFFICES’ TO HELP FIND A SOLUTION

According to the Ministry of External Affairs, the two leaders discussed key regional and global issues, including the con-

licts in West Asia and the Black Sea region. The instability in these areas has affected maritime trade and raised concerns over the safety and security of Indian seafarers.

Modi told Putin that "dialogue and diplomacy" remain the way forward in resolving conflicts and said India was ready to assist in peace efforts. He had made a similar call during a meeting with Putin in 2022, when he said that "today's era is not an era of war".

The talks between Modi and Putin also covered closer economic cooperation. They discussed implementation of the Programme for Economic Cooperation 2030 and cooperation in infrastructure, energy, technology, defence and culture.

"Delighted to meet President Putin in Delhi, less than two weeks after our meeting in Bishkek," Modi said in a post on X, adding that the two sides discussed ways to strengthen trade and cooperation across several sectors.

CONTINUED ON P4

LG VINAI KUMAR SAXENA LAUNCHES A MEGA PROJECT

Ladakh taps glacier stream to revive Tso Kar Lake

OUR CORRESPONDENT
Leh, September 13



A major effort to revive Ladakh's rapidly shrinking Tso Kar Lake is underway, with authorities diverting glacier water that currently flows unused into the Sindhu River to replenish the high-altitude lake. The project, launched by Lieutenant Governor Vinai Kumar Saxena, aims to channel up to 320 million litres of water a day from the Rupsho Kharnak glacier stream into Tso Kar, which has lost nearly 70 per cent of its area over the past decade. The lake,

once spread across about 11,000 acres, now covers only around 3,200 acres.

The Rupsho Kharnak

stream is located nearly 11 km from Tso Kar, with its source at an altitude of about 18,000 feet. Its peak

summer discharge is estimated at 132 cusecs, equivalent to roughly 320 million litres a day. Officials expect

RESTART

- » Rupsho Kharnak glacier water will replenish the lake
- » Up to 320 million litres daily will be diverted
- » The stream's peak discharge reaches 132 cusecs
- » Rupsho Kharnak lies 11 km from Tso Kar
- » Tso Kar has lost nearly 70% of its area



- » Lake area shrank from 11,000 to 3,200 acres
- » Officials expect restoration within one year
- » Work began September 2 ahead of harsh winter

the diversion of this water to restore the lake to its earlier extent within a year.

CONTINUED ON P4

Shah says UCC will be implemented in 21 NDA-ruled states before 2029

OUR CORRESPONDENT
Mumbai, September 13

The Uniform Civil Code will be extended to all 21 states ruled by the BJP-led NDA before the 2029 Lok Sabha elections, Union Home Minister Amit Shah said on Sunday, setting out the Centre's timeline for one of the government's most politically significant reforms. Shah said the code, which seeks common personal laws for matters including marriage, divorce, inheritance and adoption irrespective of religion, has already

been introduced in several states.

"We have introduced the Uniform Civil Code in several states. I am confident that we will implement the UCC in all 21 states governed by the BJP-led NDA before 2029," Shah said at a press conference in Mumbai.

The statement puts the UCC at the centre of the BJP-led government's agenda for the remaining period before the next general election. Shah linked the move to other changes in personal

CONTINUED ON P4

Truck drivers nabbed after man dies following assault

Family alerted police after victim’s condition worsened

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, September 13

A man died at a Delhi hospital days after he was allegedly tied up and thrashed with belts, fists and kicks by truck drivers who suspected that he was attempting to steal cables from their vehicles in outer north Delhi’s Bhalswa Dairy area, an official said on Sunday.

Police have arrested two men after the incident. Ram Kumar (18), a resident of Kalandar Colony, was allegedly caught along with four others by truck drivers while they were attempting to steal cable and other articles from trucks in the evening of August 29, he said.

Police said Kumar’s brother made a PCR call about the incident and claimed that the truckers allegedly beat him up.

“On August 30, Kumar’s family took him to Burari Hospital, where a medico-legal case (MLC) was prepared. Kumar was examined for bruises and laceration on his hand, a black eye and bruising on his leg, among other injuries. No vital or grievous injury was observed, and there was no active bleeding, loss of consciousness or vomiting,” the officer said.



CLOSER LOOK

- » Police said Kumar’s brother made a PCR call about the incident and claimed that the truckers allegedly beat him up
- » ‘On August 30, Kumar’s family took him to Burari Hospital, where a medico-legal case (MLC) was prepared’
- » ‘Kumar was examined for bruises and laceration on his hand, a black eye and bruising on his leg, among other injuries. No vital or grievous injury was observed, and there was no active bleeding, loss of consciousness or vomiting’
- » He was provided treatment and discharged from the hospital. The matter was looked into at that time, but the family refused to take legal action

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at that time, but the family refused to take legal action.

Kumar again visited Burari Hospital on September 9 for a check-up and complained of breathlessness.

He was subsequently referred to the Babu Jagjivan Ram Memorial Hospital and later to Rajan Babu Institute of Pulmonary Medicine and Tuberculosis Hospital. He died at Rajan Babu TB Hospital on the intervening night of September 9 and 10, the officer said.

Following information about his death, a PCR call was received at Bhalswa Dairy police station at 12:36 am on September 10, regarding the death of a man who had earlier been beaten over suspicion of theft, police said.

“An FIR was registered and the two accused, identified as Muntiyaz and Naeem, both truck drivers were arrested. Teams were constituted to trace the remaining accused and have been dispatched to different locations,” the officer said.

The post-mortem of Kumar was conducted on September 12 to ascertain the exact cause of death. Further investigation is underway, he added.

Four-storey building evacuated after sudden tilt

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, September 13

A four-storey building in Delhi’s Gandhi Nagar area that developed a sudden tilt was vacated on Sunday, with the Municipal Corporation of Delhi (MCD) directing its owner to demolish the structure voluntarily, an official said.

The civic body has asked the owner to carry out the demolition on Sunday, failing which the MCD will initiate necessary action under the applicable provisions, a civic body official said.

According to the officials, the building in Shahdara was immediately evacuated after it developed a tilt, triggering panic among residents in the vicinity.

Police cordoned off the area and prevented people from approaching the structure as a precautionary measure, officials said.

An MCD team also reached the spot and inspected the condition of the building.

The authorities are keeping a close watch on the situation to ensure the safety of people living in the surrounding area, the official said. Last week, a five-storey building housing a boys’ hostel in Satya Niketan, Delhi collapsed, killing seven and leaving several injured..

Constable removed from BRICS ‘26 duty over social media posts

PRAJYOT DEOGHARE
New Delhi, September 13

A Delhi Police constable has been removed from BRICS Summit 2026 security duty and faces departmental action after videos showing his guns and locations where he was deployed for security were widely circulated on social media.

The policeman, who was carrying a BRICS Summit ID card, had allegedly been uploading videos related to the event on an Instagram account for several days. Some of the videos showed his guns as well as locations where he was posted for security duty.

The videos were widely shared on social media, with netizens questioning why a policeman deployed for security at a high-profile international event would share such sensitive information online.

Delhi Police took cognisance of the matter after the videos surfaced. During the probe, officials learnt that the constable is posted in the force’s Northwest district and had been temporarily deputed for BRICS security. Departmental action has been initiated against him, and officials said he would be suspended from duty.

According to senior police officials, the constable is posted with the Bangladeshi Cell, where personnel conduct raids



DURING THE PROBE, OFFICIALS LEARNT THAT THE CONSTABLE IS POSTED IN THE FORCE’S NORTHWEST DISTRICT AND HAD BEEN TEMPORARILY DEPUTED FOR BRICS SECURITY

and collect intelligence inputs and details about foreigners staying illegally in the city.

The constable had been deployed on temporary duty for BRICS security at and around five-star hotels and other key locations linked to the 18th BRICS Summit 2026, where foreign delegates and dignitaries are staying.

He has since been detached from BRICS duty and sent back to his parent unit in the Northwest district.

Authorities are examining the social media posts and videos, as well as the circumstances in which they were recorded and uploaded. They are also looking into whether the constable’s actions amounted to a violation of security protocols or orders issued by senior

police officials overseeing the summit.

The incident comes as Delhi remains on high alert for the BRICS Summit 2026, being held at Bharat Mandapam. Security agencies have put in place a tight security cordon around the venue, hotels and routes used by foreign delegates.

With several countries’ dignitaries and heads of state expected to attend the summit, police personnel have been on heightened security duty for the past few weeks and have been instructed to maintain a low profile and remain discreet about their deployments.

The department will decide the punishment against the constable after completion of the departmental inquiry into the alleged violation.

MCD carries out 11 demolitions, seals 4 properties

ANAMTA FATIMA
New Delhi, September 13

From Bijwasan in the south-west to Dilshad Garden in the north-east and the crowded lanes of Old Delhi, the Municipal Corporation of Delhi’s enforcement drive against unauthorised construction and dangerous buildings is gathering pace. On Sunday, the civic body carried out 11 demolition actions and sealed four properties across its 12 zones for alleged violations of the Master Plan of Delhi (MPD) and building bye-laws.

The latest exercise comes a day after the MCD carried out a larger enforcement operation,

demolishing 33 properties and sealing five others for violations of building regulations.

The actions on Sunday were spread across several parts of the city. Demolition work was reported from Bijwasan in the South West Zone, Dilshad Colony and Dilshad Garden in the North East Zone, besides multiple locations in the Old Delhi Zone. Sealing action was carried out in the East and Old Delhi zones. While the demolitions and sealing operations form the visible part of the enforcement exercise, the civic body is simultaneously undertaking a wider survey of buildings being used as paying



guest (PG) accommodation across Delhi.

Focus shifts to PG accommodations

The MCD is conducting a field survey of PG buildings to prepare a database of properties where such facilities are operating and assess their compliance with applicable building regulations.

So far, around 2,114 buildings operating as PG

accommodations have been identified through the survey, according to the civic body.

The exercise could provide the MCD with a clearer picture of the scale and distribution of PG accommodation in the capital and help it decide on further action wherever violations are detected.

The survey also expands the enforcement

exercise beyond individual cases of unauthorised construction to the manner in which buildings are being used.

For the MCD, the immediate focus remains enforcement against unauthorised constructions, dangerous buildings and other violations of the MPD and building bye-laws. The civic body has said that the action will continue across all 12 zones.

With demolitions and sealing operations being carried out alongside the city-wide PG survey, the exercise marks a broader attempt by the civic body to map and act against building violations across Delhi.

PRAJYOT DEOGHARE
New Delhi, September 13

A 30-year-old man died after reportedly falling from a rooftop in Namdev Gali in the Gandhi Nagar area early Sunday morning, police said.

A PCR call was received at Gandhi Nagar Police Station at around 5:20 am, reporting that a man was lying injured on the road. A police team reached the spot and found the man injured. He was later declared dead.

The crime and forensic teams were called to the spot to collect evidence. Police are investigating whether Deepak accidentally fell from the rooftop

or was pushed, and are examining the circumstances surrounding his death.

The body has been sent for post-mortem examination to establish the precise cause of death and nature of his injuries. Police are also verifying his whereabouts and activities before the incident and examining whether anyone else was present at the spot.

Deepak was a native of Kishanganj Pipla in Bihar, police said.

Police said no conclusion has been reached yet and all possible angles are being examined. Further action will be taken based on the findings of the investigation.

Police takes up over 2,300 grievances during weekly ‘Thana Divas’

Strengthen police-public interaction



OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, September 13

The Delhi Police took up 2,333 complaints and grievances during its weekly ‘Thana Divas - Jan-sunwai’ public hearing sessions held across police stations in all six ranges of the national capital.

The hearings were held on Saturday as part of an initiative aimed at strengthening police-public interaction and improving grievance redressal, officials said.

Senior officers, including Joint Commissioners of Police and Assistant Commissioners of Police, attended the hearings at various police stations and interacted directly with citizens, besides monitoring the grievance redressal process.

The ‘Thana Divas-Jan-sunwai’ programme was launched in June following directions from Delhi Lieutenant Governor Taranjit Singh Sandhu.

The hearings were conducted amid heightened security arrangements in the national capital for the BRICS Summit.

Blaze at Swaroop Nagar godown leaves six injured

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, September 13

A fire broke out at a factory manufacturing judo dresses and boxing gloves in Delhi’s Swaroop Nagar area on Sunday, leaving six people in an adjacent building injured, police said.

A PCR call was received regarding the blaze. The fire broke out on the ground and first floors, used as a rexine katran and cotton webbing godown.

No one inside the factory was injured. However, panic and smoke from the blaze led to six people in the neighbouring building being injured. One person reportedly jumped from the building and injured their right leg.

Five injured people were taken to Babu Jagjivan Ram Hospital, while

MULTIPLE FIRE TENDERS WERE DEPLOYED AND THE BLAZE WAS EXTINGUISHED BY 1:50 PM. OFFICIALS ARE ASSESSING THE CAUSE AND EXTENT OF DAMAGE...

another was admitted to Government Hospital, Burari. All six are out of danger, police said.

The building comprises a basement, ground floor, first floor and tin shed, spread over around 200 square yards.

Multiple fire tenders were deployed and the blaze was extinguished by 1:50 pm. Officials are assessing the cause and extent of damage.

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, September 13

A 28-year-old man was stabbed to death allegedly by his uncle and cousin following a quarrel at their house in northeast Delhi’s Sundar Nagri, police said on Sunday.

The accused, identified as Nasiruddin and his son Javed (26), were arrested by the Delhi Police after the incident, they said.

The incident occurred around 1 am on the intervening night of September 12 and 13 when the victim, Mohammad Ali, went downstairs to get a bottle of water, according to police.

Ali’s wife claimed that Javed allegedly did not let him enter the kitchen, leading to an argument between them. The quarrel escalated, and Nasirud-



din allegedly restrained Ali while Javed stabbed him multiple times.

After the attack, the accused fled the scene.

Ali was taken to GTB Hospital by his family

members, where he succumbed to his injuries during treatment. His body has been kept at the hospital mortuary for post-mortem, a senior police officer said.

KEY POINTS

- » Ali’s wife claimed that Javed allegedly did not let him enter the kitchen, leading to an argument between them
- » Knife used in attack seized
- » The quarrel escalated, and Nasiruddin allegedly restrained Ali while Javed stabbed him multiple times
- » After the attack, the accused fled the scene: Police
- » Ali was taken to GTB Hospital by his family members, where he succumbed to his injuries during treatment

“The investigation revealed that Nasiruddin and Ali’s father, Juma Din, had been involved in a dispute over a clothes shop in Murga market. Ali’s family alleged that the property

Delhi govt steps up illegal liquor crackdown, 725 FIRs, 730 arrests

Enforcement drive intensifies ahead of festive season

AIMAN FATIMA
New Delhi, September 13

The Delhi government has stepped up its crackdown on the sale and smuggling of illegal liquor, with the Excise Department registering 725 FIRs and arresting 730 people between April and August this year.

During the five-month period, the department also seized 197 vehicles allegedly being used to transport illegal liquor and recovered around 2.20 lakh bottles.

The enforcement action has increased significantly compared to the corresponding period last year. Between April and August 2025, the department had registered 315 FIRs, arrested 312 people, seized 112 vehicles and recovered around one lakh bottles of illegal liquor.

According to officials, Delhi's geographical proximity to neighbouring states and around 70 large and small entry points make the city vulnerable to the smuggling of liquor. The Excise Department's enforcement wing has therefore been maintaining surveillance along these routes and taking action against those involved in the illegal trade.

The department has also initiated action against violations at licensed liquor establishments.



CLOSER LOOK

- » The enforcement action has increased significantly compared to the corresponding period last year. Between April and August 2025, the department had registered 315 FIRs, arrested 312 people, seized 112 vehicles and recovered around one lakh bottles of illegal liquor
- » According to officials, Delhi's geographical proximity to neighbouring states and around 70 large and small entry points make the city vulnerable to the smuggling of liquor. The Excise Department's enforcement wing has therefore been maintaining surveillance along these routes and taking action against those involved in the illegal trade

Seven FIRs have been registered in such cases, with authorities sealing estab-

lishments, imposing fines and initiating other legal proceedings.

Chief Minister Rekha Gupta said the government was adopting a zero-tolerance approach towards the illegal liquor trade.

"The Delhi government is following a zero-tolerance policy towards the illegal liquor trade," Gupta said.

She added that the government was working on a new excise policy focused on public safety, responsible regulation, quality and revenue generation.

"The government's priority is to ensure adequate availability of legal liquor during festivals so that Delhi residents do not face any inconvenience, while also effectively curbing the sale and smuggling of illegal liquor," she said.

With the festive season approaching, the department is set to intensify enforcement against illegal liquor. At the same time, the government plans to ensure adequate supplies through legal channels, including retail outlets operated by government corporations and on-premises establishments such as hotels, clubs and restaurants.

Gupta said strict action would continue against those violating the law, while the new excise policy would seek to strengthen regulation of the liquor trade and increase government revenue.

17-year-old girl dies by suicide after 'bullying'

DIPIKA KIROLA
Ghaziabad, September 13

A 17-year-old Class 12 student allegedly died by suicide at her Vaishali home on August 24, days after she was allegedly subjected to bullying, public humiliation and threats by a classmate and his family, police said. An FIR has now been registered against the student, his parents and brother for alleged abetment of suicide under Section 108 of the BNS.

The girl, a student of a private English-medium school in Delhi's Anand Vihar, was found hanging in her room. No suicide note was recovered and her parents did not initially approach the police.

The alleged harassment came to light later when the family checked her mobile phone and WhatsApp conversations. According to her father's complaint, the girl had been facing "bullying, social exclusion, abuse, humiliation and harassment". She had also stopped attending school three days before her death, but the family did not realise the seriousness of the situation.

Police said preliminary examination of WhatsApp chats and clips showed bullying after the girl left the accused classmate's group, prompting her to stop attending classes.

AI system planned to improve DTC bus ops

Platform to integrate ticketing, revenue and crew management

AIMAN FATIMA
New Delhi, September 13

Delhi's public bus network is set for a technology overhaul, with the Delhi Transport Corporation (DTC) planning to introduce an artificial intelligence-driven system to monitor fleet operations, improve punctuality and streamline maintenance.

The move comes as the Delhi government works towards significantly expanding its public transport fleet. Chief Minister Rekha Gupta had recently set a target of taking the city's bus strength to 14,000 by 2028-29, along with a possible expansion of the number of bus depots to around 90.

At present, the DTC operates around 6,269 buses, including more than 4,500 electric buses, from 52 depots across Delhi. To prepare its management systems for the expanding fleet, the corporation has invited proposals to assess its existing Bus Management System (BMS) and develop an upgraded AI- and machine learning-based platform.

The proposed system is expected to bring several operational functions under one digital framework. It will manage the allocation and tracking of Electronic Ticketing Machines (ETMs), includ-



A KEY COMPONENT WILL BE INTEGRATION WITH FARE COLLECTION SYSTEMS, ALLOWING TICKETING INFORMATION TO BE SYNCHRONISED AND REVENUES RECONCILED DIGITALLY, REDUCING DEPENDENCE ON MANUAL PROCESSES...

ing their assignment to particular buses, drivers, conductors and duties. The system will also track their issuance, return and usage.

A key component will be integration with fare collection systems, allowing ticketing information to be synchronised and revenues reconciled digitally, reducing dependence on manual processes.

The upgraded platform will also be capable of responding to real-time changes in bus routes, including diversions or alterations ordered by traffic authorities.

For electric buses, the system is expected to use AI to optimise charging schedules and battery usage. Other proposed features include predictive maintenance, detection of operational irregularities, passenger-count monitoring and CCTV-based surveillance.

The technology will also analyse traffic and historical journey data to improve estimated arrival times, anticipate delays and assist in route, fleet and depot allocation. Crew scheduling is also expected to be brought under the system, officials said.

Briefs

13-yr-old boy crushed by truck in Gzb

GHAZIABAD: A 13-year-old boy was killed after a truck allegedly hit him while he was sleeping on a cot outside his father's shop near Kallugarhi railway crossing in Dasna Dehat on Sunday morning. Akram was rushed to MMG Hospital, where doctors declared him dead. Masuri police inspected the spot and sent the body for postmortem. Police are identifying the truck driver and investigating the accident further.

Youth stabbed in northeast Delhi robbery

NEWDELHI: An 18-year-old youth was allegedly stabbed and robbed of his scooter and some cash by two juveniles in northeast Delhi's Chauhan Bangar area, an official said on Sunday.

Police said two juveniles have been apprehended in connection with the incident that took place around 5:15 am on Saturday.

The accused allegedly stabbed Aabid who works at a crafting factory in the area and fled with his scooter and cash.

He was immediately shifted to JPC Hospital for treatment, following which an FIR was registered at Jafraabad police station.

The two accused, both aged around 17, were apprehended; further investigation is underway.

Sandhu stresses research, AI in women's healthcare

SHIVANGI SHUKLA
New Delhi, September 13

Delhi Lieutenant Governor Taranjit Singh Sandhu on Saturday inaugurated the 48th Annual Conference of the Association of Obstetricians & Gynaecologists of Delhi (AOGD), calling for a life-course approach to women's healthcare with greater emphasis on prevention, early diagnosis, treatment, research and awareness.

The conference, themed "With HER: Heal, Empower, Respect... Every Step of the Way," focuses on women's health from adolescence and reproductive care to pregnancy, childbirth and ageing.

Sandhu said Delhi, home to several leading

medical institutions, has a responsibility to emerge as a hub for advanced treatment, medical research, innovation, training and public-health leadership.

He said women's health was central to India's social and economic progress, while noting challenges including anaemia, high-risk pregnancies, cancers and unequal access to quality care.

The L-G highlighted the potential of artificial intelligence, advanced imaging, telemedicine and data-driven research in diagnosis and personalised care, and urged collaboration among hospitals, universities, researchers and policymakers to improve health outcomes.

Delhi tightens vehicle testing to curb pollution

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, September 13

Delhi's pollution battle is set to move from the roads to the testing centres, with the government planning cameras at every PUC centre and expanding automated fitness testing for commercial vehicles. The move is aimed at tightening scrutiny of vehicle emission checks and fitness certification, Chief Minister Rekha Gupta said.

The move comes amid concerns over the effectiveness of pollution testing, particularly at centres operating near petrol pumps. The government also announced the opening of automated vehicle testing stations at Tehkhand and Nand Nagri for commercial vehicles, with the facilities designed to

reduce manual intervention in fitness certification. Gupta said the government identified gaps in the existing vehicle testing system while working on measures to tackle pollution.

"While working on solutions to pollution, we identified a major gap. Commercial vehicles were getting fitness certificates from centres using old technology, while private vehicles were getting pollution certificates from booths outside petrol pumps," she said.

To address the issue, the government has decided to strengthen surveillance at PUC centres. "We decided to strengthen monitoring. Every pollution centre will be upgraded and equipped with cameras," Gupta said.

The two new automated testing stations are



“MOVE COMES AMID CONCERNS OVER THE EFFECTIVENESS OF POLLUTION TESTING...”

equipped with digital systems intended to make commercial vehicle fitness tests more transparent and reduce the scope for manual interference. The facilities will conduct checks covering emissions,

GOVT PLANS 10 MORE FACILITIES AT METRO STATIONS

Arpan Centres collect 41 tonnes of old clothes

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, September 13

More than 41 tonnes of old clothes have been collected at 10 Arpan Centres set up at Delhi Metro stations, with the discarded garments being reused, upcycled and recycled into useful products, Delhi Chief Minister Rekha Gupta said on Sunday.

As of August 31, a total of 3,940 people had deposited 41,181.59 kg of clothes at the centres. The highest collection was recorded at Dr Baba Saheb Ambedkar Hospital Metro station at 9,861.40 kg, followed by Shalimar Bagh at 9,761.03 kg.

Punjabi Bagh West collected 6,534.98 kg, while Shahdara received 6,386.08 kg. The remaining centres are at Mayur



Vihar-I, Hauz Khas, Dwarka-Kakrola, Malviya Nagar, Lajpat Nagar and Mohan Estate.

According to the Delhi government, around 4,266 kg of the collected material has been earmarked for reuse and upcycling, while 29,424 kg has been sent for recycling.

Self-help groups are using the collected clothes

to make products including rugs, folders, key rings, pouches, bags and torans. These products are also being displayed and sold at the centres. The 10 centres have recorded total sales of 27,036 so far.

Five Arpan Centres were launched on August 3, while the remaining centres became operational on August 12 and 17.

KEY POINTS

- » As of Aug 31, a total of 3,940 people had deposited 41,181.59 kg of clothes at the centres. The highest collection was recorded at Dr Baba Saheb Ambedkar Hospital Metro station at 9,861.40 kg, followed by Shalimar Bagh at 9,761.03 kg
- » Punjabi Bagh West collected 6,534.98 kg, while Shahdara received 6,386.08 kg. The remaining centres are at Mayur Vihar-I, Hauz Khas, Dwarka-Kakrola, Malviya Nagar...
- » According to the Delhi government around 4,266 kg of the collected material has been earmarked for reuse and upcycling, while 29,424 kg has been sent for recycling

The government has proposed opening 10 more centres in January 2027 at Model Town, INA, IP Extension, Paschim Vihar West, Rajendra Place, Janakpuri West, Rajouri Garden, Greater Kailash, Dwarka Sector 10 and Chhatrapur Metro stations.

Calling the initiative an effective way to utilise old

clothes, Gupta said, "The participation of Delhi residents can help expand this system further.

Our effort is to make it easy and convenient for people to donate old clothes and ensure their maximum utilisation, thereby further strengthening efforts to make Delhi cleaner, more beautiful and greener."

IIT summit explores path from labs to mkt

ANAMTA FATIMA
New Delhi, September 13

How can research emerging from laboratories be translated into technologies that can be built and scaled in India? This question formed the central theme of the second edition of FITT Forward, a two-day summit organised by the Foundation for Innovation and Technology Transfer (FITT) at IIT Delhi.

The summit, brought together researchers, technology companies, investors and entrepreneurs to discuss India's prospects in artificial intelligence, semiconductors, space technology, biotechnology and agriculture.

The opening day at the IIT Delhi campus began with a discussion on whether India could develop artificial intelli-

gence systems for its large domestic market while also building globally competitive companies. The panel included IIT Delhi computer science professor Mausam, MeitY official Kavita Bhatia and Sandeep Aurora of Microsoft India and South Asia.

A separate session examined the challenges of developing advanced manufacturing and semiconductor capabilities, while another focused on the use of technology in agriculture.

The summit explored commercialising publicly funded research, with startups demonstrating innovations to investors. Discussions covered space, healthcare, biotechnology and sports technology, while FITT highlighted its incubation and funding record before concluding with Innovation Awards.

MUMBAI MONORAIL SCARE

Successful BRICS Summit gives BJP political boost ahead of Assembly polls

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
New Delhi, September 13

The successful hosting of the 18th BRICS summit here has come as a shot in the arm for the BJP, giving the ruling party a timely opportunity to bolster the narrative in its favour and counter opposition onslaught in the run-up to assembly polls due in several states next year.

According to BJP sources, the BRICS grouping's strong condemnation of the Pahal-gam terror attack in its New Delhi Declaration, adopted at the summit on Saturday, came as a "major boost" for the party and a "befitting response" to the opposition questioning the Modi government's foreign policy.

"The joint declaration, signed by the BRICS grouping, is a major diplomatic win for the Prime Minister Narendra Modi government and a signif-



icant boost for the BJP ahead of the elections next year. The opposition parties, which have been attacking the government over its foreign policy have received a befitting reply," a source in the party told PTI.

The opposition parties have intensified their attack on the Modi government on a range of issues since the Cock-roach Janta Party-led protests at Jantar Mantar in July against the alleged NEET paper leak.

"The consensus declaration adopted at the BRICS summit has further strengthened Prime Minister Modi's stature as a globally accepted leader," another source said.

The presence of Russian President Vladimir Putin, Chinese President Xi Jinping and leaders from the expanded BRICS grouping has placed India's diplomatic outreach at the centre of national attention, the source added.

According to BJP

sources, the party will highlight the outcomes of the BRICS summit during a month-long Seva Sankalp campaign to be launched from September 17 to mark the completion of Prime Minister Modi's 25 years in public life as the head of the government.

During the nationwide campaign, the BJP aims to reach out to every section of society, including youth, women and farmers, through various programmes. Assembly polls in seven states

-- Uttar Pradesh, Gujarat, Manipur, Punjab, Uttarakhand, Goa, and Himachal Pradesh-- are due to be held in 2027. Except Punjab and Himachal Pradesh, the BJP is in power in these states.

The annual summit of BRICS -- a grouping of 11 major emerging economies representing around 49.5 per cent of the global population and 40 per cent of global GDP -- concluded on Sunday with key outcomes across logistics supply chains, start-ups, and infectious disease control.

In a major diplomatic victory for India, the BRICS grouping adopted a consensus joint declaration on Saturday after overcoming sharp differences between the United Arab Emirates and Tehran regarding the West Asia conflict but skipped any direct mention of the US strikes on Iran or Iranian military's attacks on several Gulf Arab nations.

Iranian Presz Pezeshkian slams West over sanctions

MPOST BUREAU
New Delhi, September 13



and had become a manifestation of growing demand for a more balanced and inclusive world in which "no centre of power has the right to determine the destiny of others".

The BRICS now must play a greater role in building a more balanced, inclusive and just international order, the Iranian president said stressing that resilience, cooperation and sustainability should be translated into practical action.

The Iranian president said economic resilience could not be sustained without security, referring to what he described as

the military aggression by the United States and Israel against Iran.

He said the attacks on Iran's economic, energy and development infrastructure could have consequences beyond national borders, creating regional and global repercussions.

Pezeshkian said the Iranian people had paid a heavy price, with civilians killed and infrastructure built over decades damaged. The Iranian president said the international community has a responsibility to protect civilians and prevent the "normalisation of attacks on civilian targets".

From page 1

PM Modi warns

The prime minister's remarks assumed significance as they came amid growing concerns over China's restrictive policy on the export of critical minerals and its reluctance to share high-technologies.

"We may be rooted in different realities, but together, we rise through cooperation and blossom for humanity. May our diversity be our identity, our cooperation our inspiration, and our progress serve all of humanity," Modi said in the presence of top leaders of the grouping including Russian President Vladimir Putin and Iranian President Masoud Pezeshkian.

The prime minister highlighted how increasing resilience of BRICS nations is important to navigate the fractious geopolitical environment and that the New Delhi chair-ship of the grouping focused on four pillars: resilience, innovation, cooperation and sustainability.

Building on these four pillars, through BRICS, India sought to promote inclusive global growth as it believes that the benefits of solutions developed within the bloc should not remain confined to it alone and should be made adaptable and accessible to meet the needs of the Global South.

"Today, the number of conflicts and tensions in the world is continuously increasing, and this is having an increasingly negative and far-reaching impact on the lives of ordinary people.

"Pandemics, climate disasters, and supply-chain disruptions have shown that in today's interconnected world, no crisis remains confined to a single region. Therefore, within the BRICS group, we have placed special emphasis on strengthening resilience," he added.

Modi argued that it is "equally important to identify challenges in time, be prepared for them, and take prompt action".

"With this approach, we have agreed on a BRICS Integrated Early Warning System for the prevention of and response to infectious diseases.

The prime minister also elaborated on India's approach towards BRICS saying it has advanced friendship, partnership, and cooperation through various platforms of the bloc.

"Through BRICS CONNECT, we have promoted

skills, employability, women in the workforce, social security, and capacity building. To connect small enterprises with knowledge, finance, and new markets, we have initiated the BRICS MSME Cooperation Portal," he added. Modi said the BRICS Urban Mobility Hub has been established to facilitate the sharing of best practices among our cities.

"In Indian civilisation, nature has been accorded the status of a mother. For centuries, we have believed that development and the environment are not alternatives to each other, but are complementary," he said.

"Within BRICS as well, we have emphasised the need to strike a balance between human development and the environment," he added.

"For smart grids and energy storage, we have established the BRICS Digital Centre of Excellence and this will help make clean energy systems more reliable, efficient and accessible," the prime minister said.

BRICS, originally comprising Brazil, Russia, India, China, and South Africa, expanded in 2024 to include Egypt, Ethiopia, Iran, the United Arab Emirates and Saudi Arabia, with Indonesia joining in 2025. Belarus, Bolivia, Kazakhstan, Cuba, Malaysia, Nigeria, Thailand, Uganda, Uzbekistan and Vietnam became BRICS partner countries last year. (WITH AGENCY INPUTS)

China to host 2027 BRICS

The world now expects concrete results from us, not just ideas and commitments," he said, expressing confidence that member countries would live up to those expectations through collective efforts.

Modi also congratulated China, which will host the next BRICS summit in 2027, and thanked participating leaders and their teams for making the New Delhi summit a success.

"I extend my best wishes once again to China as the next host of BRICS," Modi said, before wishing the leaders and their delegations a pleasant and safe journey.

Xi proposes

The logic of "might makes right" does not hold, and should have been discarded long ago. Global South countries should jointly defend the rule of law in international affairs, safeguard the basic norms of international relations including sovereign equality, non-interference in internal affairs, and the peace-

ful settlement of disputes, and ensure that international law and international rules are applied to all, free from double standards," the Chinese President said.

In his address at the concluding session of the BRICS Summit, Xi said the Global South should jointly "defend" the rule of law in international affairs, safeguard the basic norms of global relations including sovereign equality, non-interference in internal affairs, and work towards peaceful settlement of disputes" in line with international law.

Xi Jinping stressed that all nations, regardless of their size, strength, and wealth, must be treated as equal members of the global community, and the Global South countries and nations should "hold high the banner of multilateralism, uphold the authority and role of the United Nations, support multilateral institutions in advancing reform and increasing efficiency, and ensure the equal participation of all countries in international affairs".

Xi's five-point initiative to enhance BRICS cooperation focuses on establishing an inclusive artificial intelligence framework, facilitating trade and investment, deepening digital industry ties, advancing "intelligent manufacturing", and launching a joint science and technology development initiative.

He promised that China will strive to establish a BRICS AI open-source community and will support cooperation in developing and applying large language models. He also vowed that his country will build an open ecosystem for AI.

"China will be a pioneer in establishing a BRICS AI open-source community, support cooperation in developing and applying large language models, hold specialised AI seminars and training courses, and build an open ecosystem for AI," he said.

He also proposed establishing a BRICS special economic zone partnership, under which countries can set up an intelligent portal, coordinate policies, and build a new frontier for open development.

China will push for establishing a BRICS digital ecosystem cloud platform, he said, promising his nation will impart digital skills training and promote technological exchange and industrial alignment.

The annual summit of BRICS -- a grouping of 11 major emerging economies representing around 49.5 per cent of the global population and 40

per cent of global GDP -- concluded with all leading member nations calling for a better global governance and trading architecture to navigate current challenges.

China will hold the next BRICS summit.

He also called for reform of the international financial architecture to increase the representation of developing countries.

China will be a pioneer in establishing a BRICS-AI open source community to support the cooperation in developing and applying large language models, hold specialized AI seminars and training courses, and build an open AI ecosystem, he said, about the first initiative.

On the trade and investment facilitation initiative, Xi said China proposes to establish a BRICS special economic zone partnership, under which countries can set up an intelligent portal, coordinate policies, and build a new frontier for open development.

The third initiative, he said, will be in the domain of the digital industry.

"China will push for establishing a BRICS digital ecosystem cloud platform, and conduct digital skills training, technological exchange and industrial alignment, so as to jointly enable the development of the digital economy," he said.

The fourth one, Xi said, is to have expanded cooperation in the "intelligent manufacturing".

"China stands ready to assist fellow BRICS countries in building smart factories and developing standards and norms, and jointly promote manufacturing transformation and upgrading," he said.

The fifth initiative will be in the science and technology domain.

"China proposes to set up a BRICS engineer cultivation alliance for joint development of engineers and mutual recognition of competency standards. China will launch a BRICS youth exchange programme for scientific and technological innovation, so as to cultivate more high-caliber talent," he said. (WITH AGENCY INPUTS)

Russia

India has maintained working relations with both Moscow and Kyiv and has repeatedly called for dialogue to resolve the conflict. The Kremlin has previously said that India's position on Ukraine broadly corresponds with Russia's desire for a peaceful settlement.

The outreach by Modi and Xi came as the war approaches

its fifth year, while diplomatic efforts led by Washington remain stalled. Trump recently spoke with Putin and called for a swift end to the conflict, saying peace would help restore US-Russia ties.

US envoys Steve Witkoff and Jared Kushner also travelled to Moscow and Kyiv over the weekend as part of efforts to revive negotiations, but the visits did not result in a tangible breakthrough.

Meanwhile, Ukrainian President Volodymyr Zelenskyy has said he would be willing to attend the G20 Summit in Miami if Putin also participates, raising the possibility of a first face-to-face meeting between the two leaders since the war began.

Shah says UCC

law, particularly the abolition of triple talaq, which he said had given Muslim women equal rights.

Shah made the announcement while presenting what he described as the government's record under Prime Minister Narendra Modi. He said the BJP-led governments had moved ahead on issues that had remained unresolved for decades, including changes to personal law and measures related to national security.

He also defended the government's record on internal security, citing the abrogation of Articles 370 and 35A and claiming that it was carried out without a bullet being fired or a drop of blood being shed. He said Kashmir was now fully integrated with India.

On Naxalism, Shah said the government had brought an end to five decades of the insurgency and signed more than 14 peace agreements in the Northeast. More than 9,000 people, he said, had surrendered.

Shah said surgical strikes, air strikes and Operation Sindoor had established a "zero tolerance" policy towards terrorism. He declined to comment on sensitive strategic matters involving China, saying public discussion could affect the interests of the armed forces.

The Home Minister also faced questions over the proposed National Register of Citizens in Manipur. Asked whether the 1951 baseline would be used and whether there was a deadline for the exercise, he said discussions were continuing with the Centre's allies and political parties in Manipur. "As soon as any decision is taken, we will inform you," he said.

On illegal immigration, Shah repeated the government's intention to identify

and deport illegal infiltrators. He declined to disclose the methods being used to detect them, saying that making the tools public could help those being targeted evade detection.

Shah also announced a nationwide "Seva Sankalp Abhiyan" from September 17 to October 17 to mark Modi's 25 years in public life. The campaign will involve the BJP, NDA partners, voluntary organisations and citizens and will extend from states and Union Territories to districts, constituencies and polling booths.

The campaign will include 12 categories of programmes, including musical and theatrical performances in local languages under "Untold Stories of NaMo Seva". Maharashtra Chief Minister Devendra Fadnis said the state government, BJP and NDA partners would participate.

Shah said he would also visit every state as part of the "Nasha Mukh Bharat Abhiyan", which he said would be taken to the grassroots.

Ladakh taps

The project follows the successful diversion of 90 million litres of water from the Stok Glacier into canals serving Igoo-Phey and Chuchot villages, where the water is being used to irrigate dry agricultural land near Leh.

Saxena conceived the Tso Kar project after visiting the lake on August 10, 2026. Local villagers and the village head, or nambardar, told him that Tso Kar had once been a large glacial water body that supported local salt trading and maintained an ecological balance in the area. Its decline has since left large stretches of dry land, reduced grazing areas and contributed to a fall in the number of birds visiting the lake.

Following the visit, the Public Health Engineering Department was asked to conduct a detailed survey. After 15 days of fieldwork, the department submitted its report on August 30 and proposed an 11-km reinforced concrete channel. Saxena instead called for a less intrusive approach, directing that no new concrete water channel be built and that water be taken to the first depression through a simple earthen channel.

Work began on September 2, ahead of the winter period when temperatures can fall to minus 20 to 30 degrees Celsius. From September 9, about 20 cusecs of water have been diverted from the Rupsho Kharnak stream into the first of three natural depressions along its route to Tso Kar.

Within four days, around 20 per cent of the first depression had filled.

The system uses gravity rather than pumping or new concrete channels. The first depression covers 270 acres, the second 24 acres and the third 10 acres. Check dams fitted with three RCC pipes at the outlets of each depression will help regulate the flow. From the third depression, water will travel about 400 metres into Tso Kar.

The three depressions are also expected to become freshwater wetlands, holding a combined 1,230 million litres. They will allow sediments carried by the glacier water to settle before cleaner water enters the lake. The new wetlands, visible from the Leh-Manali Highway, are expected to provide additional habitat for migratory birds.

For communities around Tso Kar, the project also has a livelihood dimension. Many local families depend on Pashmina goat herding, but the loss of grazing land has forced herders to travel 50 to 75 km from their homes in search of pasture. Officials said restoring the lake could bring back grasslands, create livelihood opportunities and allow some herders to return closer to their villages.

"By transforming untapped glacier water into permanent lifelines, Ladakh is taking decisive steps toward agricultural prosperity, revitalised rural economies, and long-term climate resilience," Saxena said, adding that the effort would help preserve Tso Kar and the ecosystem it supports for future generations.

India condemns

its assistance in the rescue operation.

New Delhi said attacks on commercial vessels, seafarers, civilians and civilian infrastructure were unacceptable and called for an immediate reduction in regional tensions through dialogue and diplomacy. It also urged the restoration of safe navigation and the movement of commerce through international waterways in the region.

The attack came a day after Prime Minister Narendra Modi proposed a "Seafarers' Emergency Support Network" at the BRICS Summit to protect mariners exposed to risks from regional conflicts.

Indian seafarers account for more than 12 per cent of the global merchant shipping workforce. About 312,000 of the world's 2.57 million seafarers are from India, second only to the Philippines. (MPOST

Briefs

EAM holds talks with Saudi FM

NEW DELHI: External Affairs minister S Jaishankar on Sunday held talks with his Saudi Arabian counterpart Prince Faisal bin Farhan Al Saud and discussed the West Asia conflict as well as reviewed bilateral ties.

The Saudi foreign minister was in New Delhi to attend the final day's session of the BRICS summit.

Assam Cong to rebuild houses

GUWAHATI: The Congress on Sunday said it has decided to rebuild flood-damaged houses in three districts of Assam and has issued instructions to party functionaries to undertake the exercise on a priority basis. The decision was taken at a meeting held on Saturday with the general secretaries of the Assam Pradesh Congress Committee and presidents of its district committees in the presence of Bhupesh Baghel, AICC general secretary and Assam in-charge.

CPI(M) veteran Baby John dies

THRISSUR: Veteran CPI(M) leader Baby John died here on Sunday after a prolonged illness, party sources said. He was 74.

A grassroot-level leader, John was a former CPI(M) state secretariat member and secretary of the party's Thirissur District Committee.

He was also a well known trade union leader.

UP govt 'misusing laws': SP

LUCKNOW: Samajwadi Party president Akhilesh Yadav on Sunday accused the BJP government in Uttar Pradesh of functioning arbitrarily, misusing laws and targeting political opponents, claiming that people did not have the freedom to raise questions under its rule.

Speaking to reporters in Lucknow, the former chief minister referred to the Allahabad High Court's observations on the invocation of the Goonda Act and termed them "extremely serious".

Bihar: SSB constable found dead

KISHANGANJ: A 24-year-old Sashastra Seema Bal (SSB) constable was found dead under mysterious circumstances while on sentry duty at an SSB camp in Bihar's Kishanganj district, officials said.

The incident took place in the early hours of Sunday at an SSB camp in Thakurganj under the Jiyapokhar police station of the district.

SIDELINES OF BRICS SUMMIT

PM holds talks with top leaders

OUR CORRESPONDENT

New Delhi, September 13

Prime Minister Narendra Modi on Sunday held bilateral discussions with South African President Cyril Ramaphosa, Philippines President Ferdinand Marcos Jr, and Egyptian President Abdel Fattah El-Sisi on the sidelines of the BRICS summit, with a focus on boosting trade and investment ties.

Modi also held a series of meetings with other global leaders, including Kazakh President Kassym-Jomart Tokayev, Indonesian President Prabowo Subianto, Burundi President Avastse Ndayishimiye, Ugandan Vice President Jessica Alupo, and Nigerian Vice President Kashim Shettima.

Officials said boosting cooperation in trade, investment, defence and people-to-people ties was a dominant theme at the meetings.

In a social media post, Modi said he and Ramaphosa reviewed the full breadth of the India-South Africa strategic partnership including cooperation in mining and critical minerals, infrastructure, food security, digital public infrastructure and emerging technologies.

"Our partnership is rooted in history and firmly focused on the future. We will work closely for Africa's progress, the priorities of the Global South and a more balanced global order," he said.

The Ministry of External Affairs (MEA) said the two



Prime Minister Narendra Modi with Egypt's President Abdel Fattah El-Sisi on the sidelines of the 18th BRICS Summit, in New Delhi

PTI

KEY POINTS

- » Modi held bilateral discussions with South African President Cyril Ramaphosa, Philippines President Ferdinand Marcos Jr, and Egyptian President Abdel Fattah El-Sisi
- » Officials said boosting cooperation in trade, investment, defence and people-to-people ties was a dominant theme at the meetings

leaders exchanged views on a range of global issues of mutual interest and agreed to maintain close coordination in multilateral fora.

"In the context of the successful translocation of cheetahs from South Africa to India, the prime minister invited South Africa to consider joining the International Big Cat Alliance," it said.

The prime minister said

he and Marcos Jr reviewed the growing momentum in the India-Philippines strategic partnership with a key focus on economic linkages, cooperation in technology, trade, space and innovation.

"We also discussed ways to further strengthen India-ASEAN engagement," he said.

The MEA said the two leaders expressed satisfaction at the progress made

Rahul, Malaysian PM meet over breakfast



OUR CORRESPONDENT

New Delhi, September 13

Leader of Opposition in Lok Sabha Rahul Gandhi on Sunday met Malaysian Prime Minister Anwar Ibrahim here over breakfast and discussed India-Malaysia ties as well as global and regional issues of importance.

Congress general secretary Priyanka Gandhi Vadra was also present during the meeting. The Congress put out pictures and a video of Rahul and Priyanka Gandhi from the meeting with Ibrahim.

In a post on X in Malay language, Ibrahim said,

"Had the opportunity once again to meet my good friend, who is also the Leader of the Opposition in the Indian Parliament, Rahul Gandhi, this morning over breakfast."

This brief meeting provided space for us to exchange views on the latest international and regional developments, the visiting Malaysian prime minister said.

Ibrahim has come to attend the BRICS summit here. Gandhi also shared pictures from the meeting on his WhatsApp channel and said he had a warm and engaging conversation with Ibrahim.

Will accept death but won't surrender: Jarange

OUR CORRESPONDENT

Jalna, September 13

Activist Manoj Jarange Patil on Sunday alleged a conspiracy to kill him and create trouble during his proposed 'peaceful' march to Mumbai to press for Maratha reservation, asserting that he will not succumb to pressure.

People associated with the ruling parties could be sent into the march to create chaos and target him, Jarange, whose hunger strike entered the 16th day on Sunday, claimed while addressing supporters and media persons at the protest site at Antarwali Sarati village in Maharashtra's Jalna district.

"I will accept death, but I will not surrender," he said, adding that the government still had eight days to resolve the issue before the proposed Mumbai agitation.

OUR CORRESPONDENT

New Delhi, September 13

The BJP on Sunday slammed the Congress over criticism of the all-vegetarian food served at the BRICS summit gala dinner, saying the Opposition party is "sulking" as India has emerged as a global consensus builder and is taking the mentality of a "naraz fufa" to the international stage.

BJP leader and Union minister Kiren Rijiju lashed out at the Congress for its criticism.

"I can't believe that the Congress party is making politics even on the food menu served to the leaders of BRICS nations. Our guests relished Indian vegetarian cuisine which are rich in flavour and nutritional variety with diverse regional traditions," Rijiju said.

Sharing a screenshot of the menu served at the dinner

India, South Africa eye deeper strategic and economic ties

Critical minerals emerge as the key focus

SIMONTINI BHATTACHARJEE

New Delhi, September 13

India and South Africa took steps to enhance their strategic relationship during the 18th BRICS Summit, which concluded here in New Delhi, where both Prime Minister Narendra Modi and President Cyril Ramaphosa emphasised trade, investment, critical minerals, and economic cooperation in their bilateral relations.

On Sunday, while speaking, President Ramaphosa lauded India's leadership role in managing the affairs of the BRICS group, helping to reach consensus and agree on the New Delhi Declaration, despite many doubts about the possibility of achieving such a consensus.

"In this BRICS Summit, we were able to adopt a declaration when many thought that we would



PM Narendra Modi with South African President Cyril Ramaphosa, in New Delhi

PTI

not succeed in adopting a declaration. We did. In that regard, we congratulate all BRICS members, but also especially India for hosting a very successful BRICS Summit," Ramaphosa commented.

Economic engagement was an important issue that formed the core of bilateral talks between India and South Africa. Economic engagement

included trade and investment, which was one of the primary topics of discussion where both countries explored means to enhance their economic engagement.

Critical minerals formed an important strategic aspect of the conversation, especially in light of their utility for electric cars, batteries, renewables, and advanced manufacturing.

'YOGI BETTER THAN AKHILESH'

BJP plans pitch for 2027 UP polls

BISWAJEET BANERJEE

Lucknow, September 13

The BJP is preparing to enter the 2027 Uttar Pradesh Assembly elections with a direct political narrative that Chief Minister Yogi Adityanath's record is better than that of Samajwadi Party chief Akhilesh Yadav's government.

The proposed "Akhilesh se behtar Yogi" narrative emerged during a

marathon meeting at the BJP state headquarters to review preparations for the Assembly elections. Party leaders suggested that the Opposition's criticism of the Yogi Adityanath government should be countered with facts and a comparison of the two governments' records.

The meeting was attended by BJP national organisation general secretary BL Santosh, state in-

charge Vinod Tawde and co-in-charge Jagdish Ishwarbhai Patel, along with state president Pankaj Chaudhary, state organisation general secretary Dharampal Singh and other senior office-bearers.

A majority of office-bearers suggested that the BJP should not get trapped in the Opposition's narrative and should instead highlight development and law and order under the Yogi govt.

DINNER MENU

Tells you of BRICS summit's success: BJP on Oppn's criticism



A photograph released by Congress leader Rahul Gandhi on X, in New Delhi

PTI

ing its "deeply problematic" dietary preferences on dignitaries from across the world, with Leader of Opposition Rahul Gandhi pointing out that 80 per cent of Indians are non-vegetarian.

PM Modi hosted the dinner for the leaders and delegates of the BRICS Summit at the Bharat Mandapam on Saturday.

In a post on social media platforms X, Facebook and Instagram, Gandhi wrote, "For the record: 80 per cent of Indians are non-vegetarian. Indian non-vegetarian food is delicious. As are my sister's chole bhature."

He also posted a picture of chole bhature on a dining table.

Reacting to Gandhi's criticism, BJP national spokesperson Pradeep Bhandari said, "When the Opposition has nothing except the food menu to criticise about the summit, it tells you how successful BRICS has been."

The Congress on Sunday said the BJP is now impos-

TO STRENGTHEN ACT EAST, INDO-PACIFIC OUTREACH

India deepens its strategic partnership with Philippines

SIMONTINI BHATTACHARJEE

New Delhi, September 13

Prime Minister Narendra Modi and President Ferdinand R Marcos Jr. of the Philippines on Sunday decided to strengthen their strategic partnership with defence and security, trade and investment, space and fintech, railways and emerging technologies becoming important areas of cooperation, as India aims to enhance its strategic presence in the Indo-Pacific Region.

The bilateral discussion held on the sidelines of the 18th BRICS Summit here in New Delhi gained impor-



PM Modi with Philippines President Ferdinand R Marcos Jr, in New Delhi

PTI

tance as the Philippines attended the BRICS Summit, being the ASEAN chair country currently.

Prime Minister Modi

welcomed the presence of the Philippines at the Summit, highlighting India's increasing engagement with ASEAN and its larger

outreach to Southeast Asia. The two leaders expressed satisfaction with the progress made in various fields of bilateral relations and

CLOSER LOOK

- » The two leaders expressed satisfaction with the progress made in various fields of bilateral relations
- » Defence and security will probably remain the most significant aspects of the India-Philippines relationship

decided to expedite cooperation in the field of defence and security, trade and investment, space, railway infrastructure, fintech, education, tourism, science and technology and innovation.

Defence and security will probably remain the most significant aspects of the India-Philippines relationship.

The evolving relationship in defence cooperation between India and the Philippines has already become strategic in nature, with the Philippines being the first foreign purchaser of the Brahmos supersonic cruise mis-

sile systems. The relationship has further moved on from simply defence sales and now includes military exchanges, maritime cooperation, joint exercises, training, and military cooperation more generally. For India, the Philippines has an important place due to its geographical location in the Western Pacific region.

The significance of the Philippines to India transcends the bilateral context. As an ASEAN member and also currently holding the office of the ASEAN Chair, the Philippines holds a significant position for India in its Act East Policy.

others.

He described the alliance as credible and honest, saying it was loyal to the people of Goa.

Kejriwal said both parties were equal partners in the alliance.

Sardesai said the tie-up would provide an alternative to a government which, he alleged, was full of defectors.

He said the BJP had not received a complete mandate in the previous elections and that even the Congress leadership could not deny the possibility of another round of defections.

CM TERMS ATTACKS ON CIVILIANS ‘COWARDLY’

Suspected Manipur militants gun down four in two districts

OUR CORRESPONDENT
Imphal, September 13

At least four people including two women were killed when suspected militants attacked their villages in Manipur’s Tamenglong and Noney districts on Sunday, police said.

The Tamenglong incident occurred at about 4 am leaving two persons dead, while the second one that took place around 12 hours later also claimed two lives.

Chief Minister Y Khemchand Singh expressed deep anguish over the killings, saying that violence against innocent civilians is a cowardly act and unacceptable.

The killings coincided with “Sahnit Ni” of “Black Day”, which is observed annually on September 13 by the Kuki community in Manipur to remember the victims of ethnic violence during the Kuki-Naga conflict in the state in the 1990s.

A woman, identified as Lhingngai Singsit, was killed, and her husband Seineih Singsit and infant son were injured in their residence when suspected militants attacked Tollen Kuki village, located near NH-37, which connects Imphal with Jiribam.

Following the incident, security forces reached the village and provided medical assistance to the injured, police said.

Seineih later succumbed to his injuries



HIGHLIGHTS

- » The Tamenglong incident occurred at about 4 am leaving two persons dead, while the second one that took place around 12 hours later also claimed two lives
- » Following the incident, security forces reached the village and provided medical assistance to the injured, police said
- » - In a statement, the village authority urged the administration to conduct an impartial investigation, identify those responsible and bring them to justice

on the way to a hospital at Silchar in neighbouring Assam, officials said.

The Kaimai Village Authority condemned the attack, describing it as a “deliberate and malicious attempt to create disharmony and division among communities”.

In a statement, the village authority urged the administration to conduct an impartial investigation, identify those responsible and bring them to justice.

In the second incident, a woman and a man were shot dead by armed mil-

itants at Longpi village under Nungba Police Station limits around 3:30 pm.

The deceased were identified as Julie Gangte and R Gangte, police said.

In a statement issued by the Chief Minister’s Office, Singh condemned the killings.

“Such cowardly acts of violence against innocent civilians are unacceptable and have no place in our society,” the CM said and extended condolences to the grieving families.

BJP leader and former chief minister N Biren

Singh and Naga Peoples’ Front legislator Awangbou Newmai condemned the killing of Lhingngai.

In a social media post, Singh said the incident at Tollen Kuki village is “deeply disturbing and heartbreaking”.

“The safety and security of innocent civilians must remain our foremost concern. Such violence only adds to the suffering of ordinary people and further undermines the fragile path towards peace,” he said.

In a statement, Newmai said, “Targeting unarmed men, women and children is a cowardly act that has no place in civilised society.”

The ethnic conflict that erupted in May 2023 between the valley-based Meitei and the hill-based Kuki communities has claimed at least 306 lives, with 49 individuals remaining missing and thousands left homeless.

Decolonise Indian knowledge: Shah

Says process of decolonisation should not involve erasing history

OUR CORRESPONDENT
Mumbai, September 13

Union Home minister Amit Shah has called for renewed efforts to preserve and spread India’s intellectual heritage from an Indian perspective, saying the process of decolonisation should not involve erasing history but presenting it in its complete and authentic form.

Shah was speaking after the inauguration of the ‘Ganesh Gyanarthi Exhibition’ being organised by the Asiatic Society of Mumbai. Maharashtra Chief Minister Devendra Fadnavis, Deputy Chief Minister Eknath Shinde and Asiatic Society president Vinay Sahasrabudhe were among those present.

Shah said that nations, which fail to preserve their memory, history, values, languages, records and traditions, eventually become



Union Home minister Amit Shah

MPOST

weak, while India’s knowledge tradition has withstood the test of time, despite centuries of foreign rule.

India’s history and knowledge had been interpreted through a colonial lens, which sought to undermine people’s confidence, “Decolonisation does not mean erasure,” he said, adding that history should be placed before the world in an authentic manner and from an

Indian perspective.

Referring to the Asiatic Society’s rare collections, Shah said that manuscripts and works relating to the Mahabharata, Jain Kalpasutra and Buddhist traditions represented an important national knowledge resource.

He urged the Society to leverage its manuscript collections, and tie it up with the government’s Gyan Bharatam National Manuscript Mission and

Dipke ‘resigns’ as MP CM in satirical jab over Balaghat tribal deaths

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, September 13

In a satirical swipe at the Madhya Pradesh government, Cockroach Janta Party (CJP) founder Abhijeet Dipke on Saturday announced his “resignation” as the state’s chief minister, a post he does not hold, to highlight the deaths of more than 30 tribal children in Balaghat and question the government’s response.

The announcement came after Dipke visited

Adori, Korka and Bondari villages in Balaghat, where he met families of children who allegedly died from infectious diseases and gathered information about healthcare facilities.

“I hereby resign as the chief minister of MP with immediate effect. I thank Hon’ble PM @narendramodi ji for giving me the opportunity to serve the people of MP, an opportunity in which I have clearly failed,” Dipke wrote on X.

He also shared a pur-

ported resignation letter addressed to the Madhya Pradesh Governor, in which he said he accepted responsibility for the deaths and questioned the response to the tragedy.

“My conscience does not allow me to continue occupying this chair after the deaths of more than 30 Tribal children in Balaghat. As Chief Minister, I accept responsibility for failing to provide them with the timely medical care and support they needed,” he wrote.

Over 48 lakh affected in Bihar flood

OUR CORRESPONDENT
Patna, September 13

Over 48 lakh people remained affected in flood-hit Bihar on Sunday, even as waters started to recede in most rivers which had been flowing above the danger mark, officials said.

Bihar has received 111.7 mm of rainfall so far in September, around 13 per cent above normal, officials said.

Around 48.70 lakh people in 575 gram panchayats across 88 blocks of 15 districts were affected by the deluge, they said.

Among the worst-affected districts are Patna, Bhojpur, Saran, Vaishali, Bhagalpur, Begusarai, and Araria, according to the Disaster Management Department (DMD).

The Kosi was flowing above the danger mark at Baltar and Kursela, the Burhi Gandak at Khagaria, the Ganga at Digha, Gandhi Ghat, Hathidah, Bhagalpur, Kahalgau and Munger, the Punpun at Sripalpur, the Bagmati at Benibad and the Ghaghra at Darauli and Gangpur Siswan, the DMD said.

The administration is operating 1,257 community kitchens, and 13 relief camps are in flood-affected areas. Arrangements for accommodation, food, medical care and other essential items have been made for around 12,260 people at these facilities, it said.

Around 1,790 boats are being used for evacuation and transportation, it said.

Ten teams of the National Disaster Response Force (NDRF) and 27 of the SDRF have been deployed in various districts.

Briefs

Punjab: Blast inside police station

FAZILKA: An explosion struck the City Police Station in Fazilka’s Jalalabad early Sunday, shattering the window glass of two cars, police said.

There were no casualties. The cars had been kept as evidence in the station’s premises.

Guj: 1 killed in house collapse

AHMEDABAD: One person was killed and three others were injured after an old two-storey house collapsed in Ahmedabad on Sunday, officials said.

The incident occurred in the afternoon in a narrow lane in the Khadia area, where four persons were trapped under the debris, a fire department official said.

Nine die in dry Naga’s Tuensang

TUENSANG: Nine people died in two days in dry Nagaland’s Tuensang district recently, and the police on Sunday said that the deaths were “circumstantially” linked to the consumption of spurious liquor.

The deaths were reported in Tuensang town and Chendang Saddle village on September 10 and 11.

Noida DM moves SC against Allahabad HC order reprimanding her Student’s detention under NSA

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, September 13

Gautam Buddh Nagar district magistrate Medha Roopam has moved the Supreme Court against an Allahabad High Court order which directed that a compensation amount of Rs 5 lakh be deducted from her salary over the detention of a student under the National Security Act during the Noida workers’ protest in April.

On September 2, the high court quashed the detention of Akriti Chaudhary, a 25-year-old Delhi University history graduate, who was taken into custody under the National Security Act in connection with the Noida workers’ protest in April.

Allowing Chaudhary’s habeas corpus petition challenging her arrest, the high court found that the detention was

based on a story “ concocted” by the state and directed her immediate release if her arrest was not warranted in any other case.

It had strongly criticised the manner in which the detention order was passed by Roopam and warned that continued “despotic” conduct by “errant” bureaucracy could reduce Uttar Pradesh to an Orwellian dystopia.

It also awarded Rs 5 lakh compensation to Chaudhary and directed that the amount be recovered from the salary of Roopam, who passed the detention order, as well as other officers responsible right down to the SHO.

On September 9, Solicitor General Tushar Mehta told the Supreme Court that an appeal would be filed against the high court decision quashing the detention order.

CM Saini: Wrong policies, leadership responsible for Punjab’s plight

MPOST BUREAU
Chandigarh, September 13

Haryana Chief Minister Nayab Singh Saini on Sunday attacked the Aam Aadmi Party government in Punjab, saying that the people of Punjab want development, employment, security for industries and solutions to their problems, not jokes, publicity and advertisements.

There has never been any shortage of ability or hard work among the people of Punjab, but the policies, intentions and leadership of governments that have failed to provide the state with the right direction have pushed Punjab behind in the race for development.

The Chief Minister was addressing a public meeting organised at Kakrala village in Patiala on Sunday. Former minister Preet Kaur, Professor Malkit Singh and other dignitaries were present on the occasion.

On this occasion, hun-



Haryana Chief Minister Nayab Singh Saini during the public meeting in Kakrala, Patiala

MPOST

dreds of people joined the Bharatiya Janata Party. The Chief Minister welcomed all those who joined the party.

Saini said that although Punjab and Haryana are two separate states, their roots, culture and heritage are one. Paying homage to this great land of Gurus, Pirs and martyrs, he said that the people of Punjab are now asking why Punjab has fallen behind despite having fertile land, hardworking people and immense potential.

The Chief Minister said that at one time Punjab was counted among the most prosperous states in the country. Haryana, which came into existence nearly 19 years after Punjab was formed, has today moved far ahead of Punjab in terms of economic progress. In 2025-26, Haryana’s real economic growth rate is estimated at 9.5 per cent, while Punjab’s growth rate is only 6.1 per cent. Thus, Haryana is progressing 3.4 percentage points faster than Punjab.

Weaving: Skill that once adorned homes now set to help run them

In Chhattisgarh’s northernmost Jashpur, the loom is emerging as a new source of livelihood

OUR CORRESPONDENT
Raipur, September 13

Jashpur, the remote northern district of Chhattisgarh, a new story of change is taking shape in its villages. A weaving skill preserved in homes for generations is now moving beyond tradition to become a source of income, employment and small-scale enterprise.

At the centre of this transition is the livelihood complex at Gholeng, where efforts are underway to give traditional skills of local women a new form suited to modern requirements.

At Gholeng, around 35 to 40 rural families and



women associated with Self-Help Groups are being trained in handloom and textile-related skills.

The focus is not limited to training. Production is

also being developed alongside it so that the skills acquired by women do not remain confined to certificates, but can translate into products and eventually

into income.

The women are learning to make shawls, sarees and other utility products while gaining exposure to modern technology, designs and

quality standards.

The Gholeng initiative reflects a larger national shift towards connecting India’s traditional skills with technology, markets and entre-

preneurship. Prime Minister Narendra Modi has repeatedly highlighted the potential of the handloom sector as a means of strengthening rural livelihoods and women-led development, while encouraging the preservation of India’s weaving traditions alongside innovation and modern market opportunities.

What sets the initiative at Gholeng apart is the effort to make training the beginning rather than the end of the process. Along with skill development, attention is being given to production and market readiness.

Women are learning to use modern technology

and machines to produce textiles, including shawls, sarees and other products. They are also being introduced to aspects such as product quality, design and changing market demand.

For rural skill programmes, one of the biggest challenges is what happens after training. Gholeng is attempting to address precisely that gap.

Learning to make a textile product is only the first step. The larger questions are what products consumers want, what designs are likely to sell, how quality can be maintained and how the finished product can reach customers.

CLOSER LOOK

- » At Gholeng, around 35 to 40 rural families and women associated with Self-Help Groups are being trained in handloom and textile-related skills
- » For rural skill programmes, one of the biggest challenges is what happens after training. Gholeng is attempting to address precisely that gap

EDITORIAL

New Strategic Vulnerability

PM Modi’s warning at the BRICS Summit against the “weaponisation” of technology and critical minerals deserves attention beyond the diplomatic setting in which it was delivered. The minerals that power electric vehicles, batteries, renewable-energy systems, semiconductors, electronics and advanced defence equipment are rapidly becoming what oil was to the industrial economy: indispensable inputs whose supply can determine a nation’s economic and strategic room for manoeuvre. For India, this creates a vulnerability that cannot be addressed merely by securing mines. The more difficult problem lies in the extraordinary concentration of processing and refining capacity in a handful of countries, particularly China. India remains fully dependent on imports for lithium, cobalt and nickel, while its dependence is also substantial for graphite and several other strategic minerals. In rare-earth magnets, essential to electric vehicles, wind turbines, electronics and defence systems, dependence on Chinese supplies has been particularly pronounced. China’s export restrictions in recent years have demonstrated how quickly control over processing capacity can translate into leverage over manufacturing elsewhere.

India has recognised the danger. The National Critical Mineral Mission, backed by a planned expenditure of ₹34,300 crore over seven years, seeks to expand exploration, accelerate mining approvals, encourage overseas acquisitions, develop processing facilities, promote recycling and create strategic stockpiles. Its ambition to undertake 1,200 exploration projects, auction 100 blocks and secure at least 50 overseas mining assets by 2030-31 is significant. The ₹1,500-crore incentive programme for recovering critical minerals from batteries and electronic waste is equally important. But mineral security cannot be measured simply by the number of blocks auctioned or foreign mines acquired. A country may possess access to ore and still remain dependent if another nation controls the technology and industrial capacity required to separate, refine and convert it into usable materials. India’s own policy assessments acknowledge vulnerabilities across lithium, cobalt, nickel, graphite and copper supply chains, making domestic processing the missing middle between mining and manufacturing.

The lesson from energy security is instructive. India spent decades diversifying crude-oil suppliers, building strategic reserves and strengthening refining capacity because dependence on a narrow set of sources was understood as a national risk. Critical minerals now require comparable strategic thinking. India must diversify suppliers through partnerships with resource-rich countries, acquire overseas assets, build domestic refining and separation capabilities, invest in material substitution and recycling, and maintain reserves of minerals whose disruption could halt crucial industries. Private investment will be indispensable, but government must absorb some of the early technological and commercial risk because processing projects are capital-intensive.

The green and digital transitions will not make India less dependent on natural resources; they will merely change which resources matter. Replacing imported oil with technologies dependent on imported lithium, graphite or rare-earth magnets would exchange one strategic vulnerability for another. Mineral security must therefore become a core component of economic, industrial and national-security policy. India cannot control where geology placed every mineral, but it can ensure that no single country controls the industrial chain between the mine and the factory.

Digital Leap in India’s Bond Market

REC’s ₹500-crore tokenised bond takes India towards faster, safer and more efficient debt-market settlement while keeping the familiar bond architecture intact; writes Jitendra Srivastava

Every big shift in finance begins as an idea. A decade ago, the notion that a central bank might issue money in purely digital form – as reliable as a currency note, yet able to move at the speed of the internet – was still largely theoretical. India turned that idea into reality in November 2022, when the Reserve Bank launched its wholesale digital rupee to settle government-securities trades. That quiet beginning set the stage for a more ambitious question: if money can be digital and programmable, why not the bonds it buys?

From an idea to an issue That question is the seed of “tokenisation.” A tokenised bond is not a new asset class – in essence, the token simply is the bond. It carries the same ISIN, issuer, coupon, maturity and credit rating, sits in the same depository account, and confers exactly the same legal rights as any ordinary bond. What changes is only the technology used to record ownership and move the cash. Because it is the next step after the 1990s move from paper certificates to electronic demat accounts, the market has nicknamed it “Demat 2.0.”

Towards the end of June, 2026, SEBI was searching for an issuer for the Pilot issue of corporate tokenisation bonds. REC Limited, the state-owned financier under the Ministry of Power, volunteered to be the pilot issuer and converted it into reality in September 2026, by issuing India’s first ₹500-crore tokenised corporate bond – comprising a ₹100-crore base issue and a ₹400-crore green-shoe option – with a 7.30% coupon and a tenor of one year and nine months. Demand was strong: bids touched about ₹796 crore, nearly eight times the base, and the bonds now trade on both the NSE and BSE. The headline, though, was the plumbing: buying, allotment and listing were

completed on the same day. What stays the same, and what changes For an investor, the instrument remains unchanged; only the machinery beneath it is upgraded. The corporate bond and its ISIN remain the same, along with investor rights and cash flows, credit rating and disclosures, trustee protection and covenants, and the existing regulatory and legal framework. What changes is the infrastructure through which the bond is held and settled. The bond is represented as a digital token, while the ownership record sits on a permissioned ledger. The securities wallet is linked to the investor’s demat account, payments are made through the digital rupee (CBDC), and settlement can become atomic – instant and final. The clever part: money and bond move together

In the pilot, payment is made in the RBI’s wholesale digital rupee, and the bond and the cash are linked so tightly that both change hands in the same instant – or neither does. Bankers call this “atomic” delivery-versus-payment. In plain terms, it removes the risk that one side hands over the bond but is not paid, or pays but does not receive the bond. The bond’s terms are written into the token as a small piece of software, so future coupon payments can run automatically, with far less manual reconciliation. Reassuringly, an investor needs no new demat account and no fresh KYC – the securities wallet works as an extension of the existing demat account, and the depositories manage the technology in the background.

How the pieces came together June 2020: SEBI notifies its Regulatory Sandbox, allowing regulated firms to test new financial technologies in a safe, supervised environment with real users. November 2022: RBI launches the wholesale digi-



India’s Demat 2.0 journey begins with its first tokenised corporate bond

TOKENISATION COULD MAKE BOND SETTLEMENT FASTER, SAFER AND MORE TRANSPARENT

tal rupee (e₹-W), initially used to settle government securities transactions in central-bank money. 2023-2025: Switzerland, Hong Kong and Germany conduct tokenised-bond experiments, providing global models that India studies while developing its own framework. May 2026: SEBI announces plans for a pilot project to test the tokenisation of corporate bonds. September 2026: REC issues India’s first tokenised corporate bond under Stage I – ₹500 crore at a 7.30% coupon, nearly eight times oversubscribed and settled on the same day. The challenges – and the benefits Making this real was not simple. Three problems, in particu-

lar, had to be solved together. First, a trustworthy digital settlement asset – answered by the RBI’s digital rupee, which many countries are still building. Second, a way to record tokens without forcing investors into new accounts or fresh paperwork – answered by linking the token to the existing demat account, with depositories holding the cryptographic keys. Third, doing all this without weakening any safeguard: ratings, trustees, disclosures and legal protections had to stay intact. A controlled regulatory sandbox provided the space to test the design on real users before any wider rollout. The practical benefits are immediate settlement with lower counterparty risk, automated coupon payments, and greater transparency through a shared, tamper-evident ledger, while permissioned access preserves confidentiality. A collaborative effort If the pilot has a lesson, it is that no single institution built it. It rested on quiet, coordinated effort: SEBI, which framed the sandbox and the securities architecture; the RBI enabled the funds leg through the digital rupee; REC, which volunteered to serve as the pilot issuer; and the Market Infrastructure Institutions – the stock exchanges

and depositories, with technology support from NPCI – which built and ran the shared ledger. The investors who bid with confidence gave the pilot its market test, and the intermediaries – debenture trustees, rating agencies, registrars and banks – kept every existing safeguard firmly in place. Backed by the Ministry of Power, Government of India, REC has traditionally embraced a first-mover role in initiatives of national importance – providing, in this instance, an early, real-world validation of a framework that many institutions had shaped together. Why it matters for India The stakes reach well beyond a single sale. India’s corporate-bond market has grown from about ₹17.5 trillion in FY2015 to roughly ₹53.6 trillion in FY2025. A NITI Aayog report calls a deep bond market “indispensable” for financing roads, power, factories and the climate transition as India aims to become a developed economy by 2047. While India’s corporate bond market has expanded significantly, its key constraint remains liquidity, as most investors continue to buy and hold bonds until maturity, limiting secondary-market trading. Tokenised corporate bonds can help address this gap by enabling faster, cheaper and safer settlement, gradually reducing settlement friction, improving market liquidity, and supporting a more active debt market over time. The Next Chapter The Demat 2.0 initiative and the tokenisation of corporate bonds mark a landmark step in the evolution of India’s debt markets – leveraging digital infrastructure, distributed ledger technology, and CBDC-enabled settlement while preserving existing investor protections and regulatory safeguards. The writer is an IAS officer, and CMD, REC Limited. Views expressed are personal

A Dangerous Turn in PoJK

Violence, political exclusion and electoral distrust are pushing PoJK towards deeper instability

FAULT LINES



SHANTANU MUKHARJI

THE WRITER IS A RETIRED IPS OFFICER, ADVISER NATSTRAT

Amid the ongoing trouble in Pakistan-occupied Jammu and Kashmir (PoJK), which has claimed nearly 100 lives in the past one and a half months, evidence is now emerging that Pakistan’s security forces have unleashed a new wave of terror by resorting to firing at mobs. Meanwhile, Pakistan’s Defence Minister Khawaja Asif repeated his controversial remarks, justifying Pakistan’s ceaseless and ruthless crackdown on the protesters. More disturbing is his statement that he found the agitators to be the same as “enemies like India”. Such an irresponsible and brazen remark came in the wake of renewed violence in the Rawalakot area of PoJK, where 32 protesters were killed in firing. The Defence Minister also posted his views on social media. It may be recalled that most

of those killed were activists connected with the Joint Awami Action Committee (JAAC), an outfit that Pakistan had banned for calling out human rights violations in the region. Videos showing the brutality of Pakistani forces as locals ran to save themselves are being prominently circulated, including footage of bodies lying strewn on the roads. The locals who were killed had come out on the roads to express their ire. Other areas affected by the violence include Mirpur, Sarsoha, Panjhera and Sehnsa. On its part, Pakistan condemned, on July 27, the allegedly highly provocative and irresponsible comments by Indian Defence Minister Rajnath Singh, as reported in The Express Tribune. The allegation goes on to say that the statement distorts facts regarding the UN and the internationally “recognised” Jammu and Kashmir dispute that remains on the agenda of the UN Security Council and shows the Indian government’s deliberate policy of threatening regional and international peace and security. This was articulated by Pakistan Foreign Office spokesperson Tahir Andrabi. However, such a statement falls short of any credibility. Analysing the developments in PoJK, it is important to examine their background. First, the general election of 2026 is taking place under the overhang of violent protests organised by the now-defunct JAAC. Although the agitation is the fourth wave of such protests, it seems to be the most violent and severe. According to an article in Dawn dated July 26,



Growing alienation adds another dangerous dimension to the crisis

PAKISTAN’S CRACKDOWN RISKS INTENSIFYING ANGER ACROSS AN INCREASINGLY RESTIVE POJK

fatalities among both civilians and law-enforcement personnel are just one aspect of the crisis. Although the JAAC has been declared unlawful under the anti-terrorism law and some of its leaders have been arrested, it is difficult to deny that the JAAC and its 30-point, people-centric and anti-elite charter of demands drew a large segment of the young PoJK population, particularly its Gen-Z component. Second, the election is being conducted in the absence of

two of the most popular groups. The defunct JAAC is not among the registered political parties of PoJK and is, therefore, not contesting. Some leaders and members tried to submit their nomination papers as independent candidates, but these were not accepted on one pretext or another. The other entity not contesting is the Pakistan Tehreek-e-Insaf (PTI), which has decided to boycott the election as it sees no prospect of a free and fair election. In the PoJK elections of 2021, the PTI had secured the largest share, 31.4 per cent, of the votes and formed the government. Following the PTI’s ouster, many PTI legislators in PoJK joined other parties. Consequently, the PTI government was ousted from PoJK as well. The absence of these two popular forces will likely impact the legitimacy and representative character of the Legislative Assembly. Pakistan People’s Party (PPP) Chairman Bilawal Bhutto Zardari said on July 27 that the

PoJK Legislative Assembly elections were among the most significant in the region’s political history, stressing that only a free, fair and transparent electoral process could produce a credible government capable of addressing the challenges faced by the people. Addressing a party gathering during first-phase polling in Mirpur Division, Bilawal expressed confidence in his party’s candidates. Bilawal described the elections as a defining democratic exercise and said that an election of such importance should leave no room for controversy. Further, Bilawal said his party had repeatedly expressed concerns regarding the handling of refugee seats and questioned the decision to hold the polls in three phases. He also criticised the sequence in which the phases were scheduled, saying such decisions had generated doubts about the fairness of the electoral process. Bilawal also highlighted what he described as a growing disconnect between PoJK’s youth and the political system, stressing that political challenges could only be resolved through dialogue, democratic engagement and meaningful debate. This statement merits a closer look. PoJK is already showing signs of a high degree of volatility and uncertainty. The local population seems restive and directionless. Any wrong or provocative move by the Pakistani security or political establishment may incur the wrath of the local population, and things may then spiral out of control. Views expressed are personal

LETTER



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Fresh Start?

Bangladesh’s call to “reset” ties with India should be welcomed, but durable relations require more than rhetoric. Geography, trade, connectivity and security make cooperation indispensable for both neighbours. Dhaka and New Delhi should move beyond political grievances and rebuild trust through sustained dialogue, mutual sensitivity and pragmatic engagement.

ANIRBAN DUTTA, SILIGURI

You can also send your comments to The Editor, Millennium Post, Pratap Bhawan, 5 Bahadur Shah Zafar Marg, New Delhi 110 002

News at a glance

Nepal Army chief leaves for China on week-long visit

KATHMANDU: Nepal Army chief Ashok Raj Sigdel left for Beijing on Sunday on a week-long official visit to China at the invitation of the Chinese government, during which he will attend the 13th Beijing Xiangshan Forum, according to an official statement.

Sigdel is scheduled to be in China from September 13 to 19. The visit is expected to strengthen military ties between Nepal and China and contribute to Nepal's foreign policy through military diplomacy, the army said.

Beijing bans possession of drones within city limits

BEIJING: Beijing is banning the possession of drones within city limits in new rules announced Sunday that further tighten its regulations on drones, which already include a May ban on sales of the devices. The ban on possession will come into effect in mid-November. Beijing has barred unauthorised drone flights, and has designated the city's administrative area as restricted airspace.

The rules come after a small aircraft, in late June, crashed into a skyscraper, killing the pilot and injuring 13 others.

Mourners in Rome pay last respects to Italian activist

ROME: Hundreds of people queued outside Rome's city hall on Sunday to pay their last respects to Emma Bonino, the prominent Italian politician and human rights campaigner who died on Friday, aged 78.

A Carabinieri honour guard escorted the casket into the building, where Riccardo Magi, secretary of Europa -- the party Bonino founded in 2017 -- placed a European flag on it next to a photo of an elegant Bonino wearing a black headscarf. Bonino rose to political prominence in the 1970s.

Kosovo gets new govt but political impasse persists

PRISTINA: Kosovo lawmakers on Sunday voted in a new government of Prime Minister Albin Kurti following an early election in June in the small Balkan nation that remains locked in a prolonged political crisis.

Kurti received support from a slim majority of 62 in the 120-member assembly. Opposition boycotted the session, accusing Kurti of violating procedures. Disagreements between political players have led to an impasse for over 18 months, which has not been resolved despite 2 early ballots.

‘ATTACKS CAUSING FUEL SHORTAGE’

Donald Trump calls on Ukrainian Prez to halt strikes on Russian diesel

ASSOCIATED PRESS

Kyiv, September 13

US President Donald Trump on Sunday called on Ukrainian President Volodymyr Zelenskyy to halt strikes on Russian diesel, saying the attacks are causing a fuel shortage.

Trump was asked by a reporter if he had spoken with Zelenskyy following his recent conversation with Russia's Vladimir Putin. Trump responded by calling on Zelenskyy to halt strikes against Russia.

“Mr Zelensky has to do one thing. He has to stop knocking out diesel fuel in Russia,” Trump told reporters on the sidelines of the Irish Open, which is being played at his Doonbeg golf club.

“Let him go after targets but not diesel fuel, because he's causing a shortage of diesel fuel.”

Ukraine's long-range strikes have been targeting Russia's oil and gas industry for months, which Kyiv says both funds and directly fuels Moscow's more than four-year-old invasion of its neighbour.

The Ukrainian drone campaign has caused fuel rationing across Russia, despite the country being a key oil and gas exporter.



A residential building is seen in fire after an air attack in Odesa, Saturday AP

CLOSER LOOK

» Ukraine's long-range strikes have been targeting Russia's oil and gas industry for months, which Kyiv says both funds and directly fuels Moscow's more than four-year-old invasion of its neighbour

» The Ukrainian drone campaign has caused fuel rationing across Russia, despite the country being a key oil and gas exporter. Other Ukrainian strikes targeted major Russian online retailers, bringing the war ever closer to the public

Other Ukrainian strikes targeted major Russian online retailers, bringing the war ever closer to the public.

Russia has also ramped up its air campaign against

Ukraine in recent weeks, using ballistic missiles and jet-powered drones to pierce Ukraine's defences.

Moscow's attacks have targeted Ukraine's power grid

ahead of winter in what officials say is meant to demoralise civilians.

Civilians were killed and injured overnight into Sunday as Russia and Ukraine exchanged large-scale drone strikes.

Two people were killed and 14 more injured near an oil and industrial hub in Russia's Tatarstan, according to local officials, while Ukrainian authorities reported on Russian drones pummeling the Black Sea port of Odesa and starting a fire near a border crossing

with Poland.

Ukraine targets more Russian oil facilities

The two Russian civilians died after a drone slammed into a tree near their parked car in the city of Nizhnekamsk, according to the office of regional head Rustam Minnikhanov. Nizhnekamsk houses a key cluster of oil refineries and petrochemical, rubber and polymer plants, including some of Russia's largest facilities of their kind. Mayor Radmir Belyaev said that a fire had broken out at an unspecified “enterprise.”

Ukraine also claimed on Sunday to have hit a major oil refinery in Sloviansk-on-Kuban, in Russia's Krasnodar region, across from Crimea. The Defence Intelligence of Ukraine (DIU) agency said its drones struck a key oil processing unit and the refinery's tank farm overnight.

Krasnodar authorities said the strike on “an enterprise” in Sloviansk-on-Kuban injured three people, damaged an oil pipeline and started a blaze. They did not directly respond to the Ukrainian claims.

Russia said its forces shot down 389 Ukrainian drones during the night.

Nepal flood assessment puts recovery needs at \$4.7 billion

Toll mounts to 1,388 with recovery of more bodies

PTI

Kathmandu, September 13

Nepal's recent devastating flash flood has led to an estimated USD 4.7 billion in recovery and reconstruction needs, according to a government-led assessment.

The Rapid Damage and Needs Assessment (RDNA) for the Rasuwa-Bhotekoshi Flood 2026, released by the government on Saturday, estimates a total damage of around USD 2.7 billion, with physical damage at USD 1.81 billion and economic losses at USD 883.32 million.

The assessment, led by Nepal's National Disaster Risk Reduction and Management Authority, said the larger recovery figure does not represent simply the cost of replacing what was damaged. Recovery needs include reconstruction as well as disaster-risk reduction and resilience measures.

The RDNA covers Rasuwa, Nuwakot, Dhading, Gorkha and Chitwan districts and combines sector submissions, administrative records, satellite imagery, drone surveys, geospatial data and census information. Where direct inventories were incomplete, the assessment used estimates based on mapped exposure, statisti-



A GOVT REPORT ESTIMATED THE TOTAL DAMAGE OF AROUND USD 2.7 BILLION

cal relationships and costing assumptions.

Flash floods, triggered by an ice-rock avalanche in the high Himalayas near the Nepal-Tibet border on August 26, devastated towns and villages in northern and central Nepal.

Meanwhile, the death toll in the flash floods climbed to 1,388 on Sunday as more bodies were recovered from the eight affected districts, authorities said.

According to the latest data released by the National Disaster Risk

Reduction and Management Authority, 364 bodies were recovered from Chitwan district, 230 from Nawalparasi East, 222 from Nawalparasi West, and 199 from Nuwakot.

Similarly, 185 bodies were recovered from Rasuwa, 77 from Gorkha, 71 from Dhading and 38 from Tanahun.

Two others died while undergoing treatment in Kathmandu.

Only 104 of the recovered bodies have so far been identified and handed over to their families.

The joint command of security personnel has continued its search and rescue operations, with the number of missing people estimated to be 5,130.

A total of 13,728 people have been rescued so far, officials said.

Stalker kills Indian-origin woman in US

PTI

Washington, September 13

A 38-year-old Indian-origin woman was shot dead outside a restaurant in California by a 22-year-old man from India who had allegedly stalked her for months, the US Department of Homeland Security said.

The incident took place on September 8 at a shopping centre in Sacramento and the stalker, identified as Rohit, shot himself dead in a stand-off with police.

Rohit, an undocumented immigrant from India, approached Shalini Thakur at the Arden Arcade shopping centre and shot her dead after a chase, the Department of Homeland Security said in a statement on Friday.

After the shooting, witnesses provided investigators with information about Rohit's vehicle which was located on east-bound Highway 50 near Watt Avenue. When deputies attempted to pull Rohit over, he stopped on the freeway, leading to a police standoff that brought traffic to a standstill for hours.

Rohit was later found slumped over in the driver's seat with what appeared to be a self-inflicted gunshot wound.

Briefs

Pak PM announces fuel relief...

ISLAMABAD: Pakistan PM Shehbaz Sharif on Sunday announced a special relief scheme for users of motorcycles, rickshaws and small vehicles amid a surge in fuel prices. Under the scheme, users of two- and three-wheelers will get a subsidy of PKR 100 per litre on up to 20 litres of petrol per month, whereas owners of small vehicles, up to 800cc, will receive the same subsidy on up to 30 litres.

Swedish voters go to polls

STOCKHOLM: Voters in Sweden head to the polls on Sunday for an election that will determine whether a conservative leader remains in charge and a hard-right party wins ministerial jobs for the first time, or whether the centre-left returns to power. PM Ulf Kristersson is seeking a second term.

Bangladesh: Want to ‘reset’ ties with India

PTI

Dhaka, September 13

Bangladesh on Sunday said it wants to “reset” its relationship with India and build a new bilateral engagement based on mutual interests, while describing ties during the tenure of deposed prime minister Sheikh Hasina as “uncomfortable”.

The remarks by State Minister for Foreign Affairs Humaiun Kobir came two days after Bangladesh on Thursday said Prime Minister Tarique

Rahman would not participate in the BRICS Summit hosted by India as he was not invited to the event, with the invitation instead extended to the BIMSTEC chair.

The BRICS Summit concluded on Sunday. India had invited Rahman to attend the summit as chairman of the Bay of Bengal Initiative for Multi-Sectoral Technical and Economic Cooperation (BIMSTEC), while a separate bilateral invitation had been in place since February.

Drone hits train near Ukr-Poland border

ASSOCIATED PRESS

Kyiv, September 13

A Russian drone struck a train near the Ukraine-Poland border on Sunday shortly after senior visiting officials, including the former prime ministers of the UK and Sweden, passed through, Ukraine's state rail operator said.

According to Ukrzaliznytsia, a diplomatic train carrying Boris Johnson, Carl Bildt and security advisers from several European Union states had purposely left the station at Yahodyn ahead of schedule. The visitors were on

THE ‘RUSSIAN ATTACK’ COMES SOON AFTER VISITING DIGNITARIES PASSED THROUGH

their way back from a security conference in Kyiv.

“It is highly probable that the Russian drone ‘s intended target was in fact the diplomatic train, which had departed the station earlier than scheduled,” the company said in a Telegram post.

Bildt, the former Swedish PM, shared a video on X of the attack at Yahodyn station, near the Yahodyn-

Dorohusk border crossing with Poland. “This wasn’t our train, but the one just minutes after us by the Polish border crossing,” Bildt said. “It was evacuated as the Russian drone approached and no one was hurt. Very good safety system. Our train just had an evacuation warning.”

Bildt, Johnson and fellow passengers had been in Kyiv for the Yalta European Strategy conference, which is an annual gathering of leaders and experts across politics, business, security and media.

Another train, with former CIA Director David

Petraeus on board, was still at Yahodyn station when the drone struck, according to Ukrzaliznytsia.

There were no immediate reports of casualties on any of the trains. Ukrzaliznytsia said it “constantly adjusts train schedules” to guard against strikes.

“I don’t know what warped logic drove Putin to blow up a stationary Ukrainian locomotive on the Polish border this morning... What we can say for sure is that this is the kind of random and senseless attack Ukrainians are enduring every day...” Johnson wrote on X.

VOYAGE ENDS IN DISASTER; SIX DEAD

Indonesia: Ferry capsizes, search on for 129 missing

ASSOCIATED PRESS

Bandjarmasin, September 13

The search is continuing for at least 129 people missing after a ferry overturned in bad weather in Indonesia's Java Sea on Sunday.

At least 108 people were rescued, and the bodies of six passengers were recovered as the search operation expanded around the vessel's last known position.

The ferry, with more than 240 people on board, was travelling from

Surabaya in East Java to Bandjarmasin in South Kalimantan province, on Borneo Island, officials said.

The captain had reported rough seas with waves up to 3 metres (10 feet) before issuing a distress call, saying the ship was listing, said I Putu Sudayana, who heads the Bandjarmasin Search and Rescue Office. Authorities later received information indicating the vessel had overturned.

The rescue agency in Bandjarmasin said it

INSIGHT

» At least 108 people have been rescued so far

» The bodies of six passengers were recovered during the search ops

received a report two hours after contact was lost with the Virgo Transport 8 at about 2 am Sunday.

A rescue ship was headed to the vessel's last known position, the

agency said, and by Sunday afternoon authorities were deploying teams supported by a dozen vessels, including four navy ships, and two helicopters.

Initial information indicated the vessel's last known position was in the Java Sea, about 148 kilometres (92 miles) from Bandjarmasin. The ship's manifest said it was carrying 243 people -- 213 passengers and 30 crew members -- although it is common in Indonesia for the number of passengers to differ from

the manifest. The vessel was also transporting 89 vehicles. Sudayana, who is coordinating the search, said search teams, assisted by nearby tugboats and other passing vessels, had rescued 107 people and recovered six bodies by Sunday afternoon. The 119-metre Virgo Transport 8 ferry was built in Japan in 1987 and operated there until last year before being sold to the current Indonesian operator, PT Virgo Karya Shipping.

Transportation Minis-

ter Dudy Purwagandhi said aerial searches showed the ferry was floating upside down and had not sunk. Rescuers were concentrating search efforts around the overturned ferry, he told reporters Sunday.

Videos released by the National Search and Rescue Agency showed an overturned ferry floating in choppy waters during a helicopter search operation. Separate footage captured exhausted survivors disembarking from a rescue ship.

RUSSIA IMPORTED 172,000 TONNES OF OIL PRODUCTS IN AUGUST

Russia imports record fuel from India as Ukraine strikes refineries

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, September 13

Russia imported a record 172,000 tonnes of oil products in August, including gasoline refined from Russian crude at a refinery in India that is partly owned by Russia's Rosneft, as Ukrainian drone strikes disrupted Moscow's domestic refining capacity, according to a report by the Centre for Research on Energy and Clean Air (CREA).

India supplied 70 per cent of Russia's oil product imports in August, including 120,000 tonnes of gasoline worth 78 million euros, CREA said in its monthly analysis of Russian fossil fuel exports and sanctions. The volume of Russian fuel imports was more than seven times the previous monthly record and three times the total imported during all of 2025.

All of the gasoline from India was loaded at the Vadinar refinery and sold by EU-sanctioned Nayara Energy to Rosneft, CREA said. Rosneft owns 49.13 per cent of Nayara Energy,



while Vadinar sourced all of its crude from Russia during the first eight months of 2026, compared with 81 per cent for all of 2025, according to the report.

"Russia is therefore paying a refinery that it partly owns to process its own crude into fuel it can no longer produce domestically, before shipping it back halfway around the world," CREA said.

The shipments underscore the impact of a sustained Ukrainian drone campaign against Russia's oil refineries and energy infrastructure, which has reduced domestic fuel production and contributed

to shortages, according to CREA.

Each cargo of gasoline exported from Vadinar to Russia was transferred between vessels in a ship-to-ship operation off Egypt before being unloaded at Russia's Arctic port of Beloe More, the report said. All the vessels involved were sanctioned tankers, while four of the six had previously operated under false flags, CREA said.

Russia's gasoline imports surged even as the country, historically one of the world's largest exporters of refined petroleum products, faced declining exports. Gasoline

KEY POINTS

» India supplied 70 per cent of Russia's oil product imports in August, including 120,000 tonnes of gasoline worth 78 million euros

» The volume of Russian fuel imports was more than seven times the previous monthly record and three times the total imported during all of 2025

accounted for 74 per cent of its total oil-product imports in August, compared with just 6 per cent on average between 2023 and 2025.

South Korea supplied a further 18,000 tonnes of oil products to Russia in August, mostly gasoil, while Egypt exported 25,000 tonnes of diesel worth 16 million euros, CREA said.

Russia's seaborne oil-product exports fell 21 per cent by volume in August, while revenues from products unloaded at destination ports dropped 32 per cent from July to 78 million euros per day - the lowest level since Russia's full-scale invasion of Ukraine.

Oil-product loadings at Russian ports have fallen for three consecutive months and were less than half their August 2025 level, CREA said.

Tuapse, Russia's fourth-largest oil-product export port before the full-scale invasion, did not load a single oil-product cargo for the third consecutive month after sustained Ukrainian drone attacks since May.

Ukrainian strikes also disrupted crude exports through Russia's Black Sea port of Novorossiysk.

Crude loadings there fell 58 per cent month-on-month in August, while loadings stopped for nine consecutive days, the longest reported interruption at the port since the start of the full-scale invasion, according to CREA.

Overall, Russia's fossil-fuel export revenues fell 8 per cent in August to 604 million euros per day, while export volumes declined 7 per cent. The fuel trade comes as India remained Russia's second-largest fossil-fuel customer in August, behind China.

Russian Prez Putin proposes new insurance mechanism at BRICS

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, September 13

Russian President Vladimir Putin on Sunday proposed a new insurance mechanism and a collaborative initiative for the grain market among the BRICS nations as he called upon the grouping to adopt a holistic approach in combating pressing global challenges.

Putin proposed the new initiatives for economic growth among the BRICS member nations as well as the Global South nations amid crippling sanctions imposed by the Western powers on Moscow for its war on Ukraine.

The G-7 countries, the European Union, and the UK prohibited Western companies from insuring any ship transporting Russian crude unless the oil was purchased at or below a specified price cap. The sanctions relating to the insurance sector have adversely impacted Russian crude oil exports.

The Russian president also pitched for setting up a dedicated platform for economic growth with the BRICS.

"We have independent routes for moving capital, labour and technologies.



Russian President Vladimir Putin

In fact, we can operate regardless of outside pressure," Putin said at the concluding session of the BRICS summit.

"We have some promising initiatives going forward, such as creating an insurance mechanism and a grain market. These are Russian proposals, and we invite all other member states to make use of those," he said without elaborating further.

Putin also complimented the functioning of the New Development Bank (NDB), saying it is handling projects worth USD 140 billion.

The NDB is a multilateral development bank established by the BRICS nations.

"As global challenges keep surfacing, we should adopt a holistic approach to address both the symptoms and root causes," Putin said.

"Global South countries should jointly advance better (global) governance structure and tackle both traditional and nontraditional security threats," he said.

The Russian president also said that the global stature of BRICS is rising as it has been focusing on charting an independent course to combat pressing global challenges.

"The broad participation in today's meeting confirms that international interest in BRICS continues to grow. Many around the world find our core values and ideals appealing, including our commitment to charting an independent course and a desire to resolve problems collectively, guided by international law and the key provisions of the UN Charter," Putin said.

The concluding session of the BRICS summit was attended by the bloc's full member nations as well as its partner countries.

"This format opens the door to direct, candid dialogue between full-fledged BRICS members and partner countries, as well as other states and multilateral organisations keen to work with our group," Putin said.

Oriental Insurance hopes to turn corner in FY27 assisted by NSE stake dilution

AGENCIES
New Delhi, September 13

Public sector general insurer Oriental Insurance Company is targeting a return to profit in 2026-27, aided by the planned dilution of part of its stake in NSE through its upcoming initial public offering.

"We are targeting to make some profit this year...the proceeds from the NSE IPO would be booked as profit. It will improve the company's financials. Besides, it is going to provide liquidity," Oriental Insurance Company Chairman and MD Sanjay Joshi said.

The insurer is offering about 49.57 lakh NSE shares through the IPO. As of June 30, 2026, it held 3.52 crore shares, representing a 1.42 per cent stake. At the upper price band of Rs 1,785 per share, Oriental Insurance would realise Rs 885 crore, while at the lower band of Rs 1,700 per share, it would receive about Rs 843 crore.

Joshi said the value of its remaining NSE holding after listing could be considered for calculating solvency, which is expected to strengthen.

The Rs 22,569-crore NSE IPO will open on September 17 and close on September 21, with the exchange set to list on September 24.

India and Uzbekistan discuss economic, financial cooperation

ANI NEWS
New Delhi, September 13

India and Uzbekistan are looking to deepen bilateral economic & financial cooperation, with Union Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman and Uzbekistan's Deputy Prime Minister and Minister of Economy and Finance Jamshid Kuchkarov discussing ways to strengthen engagement between the two countries.

Sitharaman met Kuchkarov in New Delhi on Sunday, with the two sides exchanging views on areas of mutual interest and exploring avenues to further strengthen economic & financial ties, the Ministry

UZBEKISTAN A KEY CENTRAL ASIAN ECONOMY, REMAINS AN IMPORTANT PARTNER FOR INDIA'S REGIONAL ECONOMIC OUTREACH

of Finance said on X.

The meeting comes as India continues to expand its economic engagement with Central Asian countries, with greater cooperation in trade, investment and financial sectors offering scope to strengthen bilateral economic links.

The discussions between the two finance

ministers focused on areas where both countries can build closer institutional and economic cooperation.

The meeting also assumes significance as India has been seeking to strengthen its engagement with Central Asia through greater economic and connectivity cooperation. Uzbekistan, as the region's most populous country and a key Central Asian economy, remains an important partner for India's regional economic outreach.

The two sides also exchanged views on issues of mutual interest, although the Ministry of Finance did not provide details of specific sectors or initiatives.

India-UAE trade to reach \$200 billion by 2032, BRICS to drive investment, says official

ANI NEWS
New Delhi, September 13

India-UAE trade is on track to expand significantly towards the \$200 billion target by 2032, with the growing role of BRICS and stronger investment linkages expected to create fresh opportunities for businesses from both countries, according to Mohammad Haseeb, Strategic Country Manager, Ras Al Khaimah Economic Zone.

Haseeb said bilateral trade currently stands at around \$101 billion, up from about \$73 billion before the India-UAE Comprehensive Economic Partnership Agreement (CEPA),

highlighting the impact of closer economic ties between the two countries.

"We have a target around 200 billion by 2032. So that is a huge," Haseeb said, adding that the next challenge was to increase awareness among businesses about the benefits available under the trade agreement.

He said India had received nearly \$25 billion in UAE investment over the past two decades, while another \$5 billion investment commitment was made recently.

More than 200,000 Indian companies are operating in the UAE, he added, underlining the

depth of the commercial relationship.

Haseeb said the relationship had expanded beyond trade and investment into tourism, technology and people-to-people ties. Around 4.5 million Indians live in the UAE, while the two countries have also developed cooperation in areas such as Unified Payments Interface (UPI), virtual corridors and emerging technologies.

On BRICS, Haseeb said the UAE's participation in the grouping, while India holds the chairmanship, could provide an additional platform for expanding trade and investment. He said the summit had

demonstrated an inclusive approach and highlighted new opportunities, particularly for startups.

"I see is a great growth and it's very inclusive growth along with the BRICS nations. And we see that a lot of trade investment is going to come," he said.

Haseeb also pointed to growing investment engagement between Indian states and the UAE. He said delegations from Punjab, Bihar, Madhya Pradesh and Odisha had recently visited the UAE to explore investment opportunities, while UAE investors were also engaging with India.

India gets 6.94 lakh tonnes of steel quota annually for exports under FTA with EU

Total country-specific quota of 16,41,470 tonnes comprises 9,46,616 tonnes under MFN, 6,94,853 tonnes under FTA

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
New Delhi, September 13

India will get country-specific tariff-rate quotas (TRQs) totalling 1.64 million tonnes annually for exporting steel products to the European Union, of which 6,94,853 tonnes will be under the free trade agreement (FTA), according to the draft text of the pact released by the EU.

The total country-specific quota of 16,41,470 tonnes comprises 9,46,616 tonnes under the MFN (most favoured nation)

component and 6,94,853 tonnes under the FTA component.

The quotas cover a wide range of steel products, including non-alloy and alloy hot-rolled sheets and strips, cold-rolled sheets, metallic-coated sheets, organic-coated sheets, tin mill products, stainless steel products, merchant bars and light sections, rebars, wire rods, pipes and tubes.

India at present exports about four million tonnes of steel per year to the EU. The TRQs follow the European

Union's Steel Overcapacity Regulation, which came into force on July 1 this year. It is aimed at ensuring protection for the EU's steel industry against the effects of global overcapacity. It sets free-of-duty quotas at 18.3 million tonnes, with a 50 per cent duty for out-of-quota imports and a melt-and-pour regime to enhance transparency.

According to the text, the largest country-specific quota is for non-alloy and other alloy hot-rolled sheets and strips at 5,09,605 tonnes, comprising 2,99,197

CLOSER LOOK

- » India at present exports about four million tonnes of steel per year to the EU. The TRQs follow the European Union's Steel Overcapacity Regulation, which came into force on July 1 this year
- » According to the text, the largest country-specific quota is for non-alloy and other alloy hot-rolled sheets and strips at 5,09,605 tonnes, comprising 2,99,197 tonnes under the MFN component and 2,10,408 tonnes under the FTA component

tonnes under the MFN component and 2,10,408 tonnes under the FTA component.

This is followed by cold-rolled sheets with a total quota of 2,18,658 tonnes and metallic-coated sheets

with 1,97,860 tonnes.

Other major quotas include 1,86,038 tonnes for organic-coated sheets, 1,81,835 tonnes for non-alloy and other alloy quarto plates, 85,157 tonnes for

another category of metallic-coated sheets and 79,278 tonnes for stainless steel bars and light sections.

It added that the TRQs relating to imports into the European Union of steel products originating in India shall take effect on the date the EU Steel Regulation starts applying.

Steel imports from India outside these quotas will attract the applicable base-rate duties under the EU's tariff commitments. "If the European Union amends the Product Specific Rules (PSRs) for products cov-

ered under the EU Steel Regulation, the European Union shall consult with India immediately upon the proposal for such an amendment," the text said. The EU would administer the TRQs, it said, in a transparent, objective and non-discriminatory manner so as to be conducive to trade and facilitate, to the extent feasible, their effective utilisation.

This includes making publicly available in a timely and continuous manner all relevant information concerning the administra-

tion of those TRQs.

It added that India will also get access to additional quota volumes in categories where India has a country-specific quota. Those additional volumes will be allocated through competition among EU FTA partners that have country-specific quotas in those categories.

India will access residual quotas for product categories where no country-specific quota exists, with quota reviews one year after implementation and every five years thereafter.

THE FINDINGS COME DAYS AHEAD OF SEMICON INDIA 2026

India's semiconductor sector draws \$1.4 bn funding, half of it since 2025

OUR CORRESPONDENT

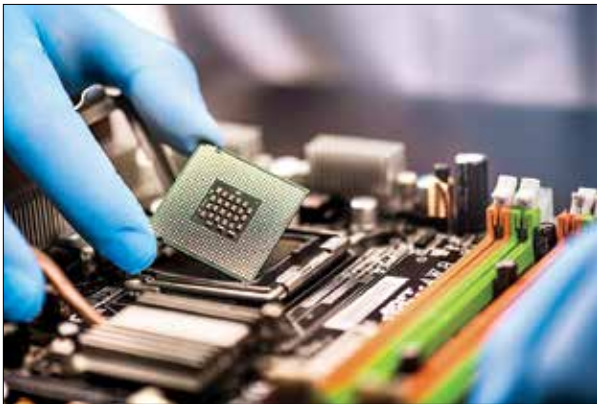
New Delhi, September 13

India's semiconductor sector has attracted \$1.4 billion in all-time equity funding across 281 funded companies, with nearly half of this amount - \$701 million - raised since 2025 alone, according to data from Tracxn.

The findings come days ahead of SEMICON India 2026, the country's flagship semiconductor conference and exhibition, which will be held from September 17-19 at Yashobhoomi in Dwarka, New Delhi.

Prime Minister Narendra Modi will inaugurate the fifth edition of SEMICON India 2026 on September 17, a mega-event set to bring together global semiconductor industry leaders, government officials, state representatives, and sector experts as India builds on the momentum of its growing semiconductor ecosystem.

India is home to 3,557 companies in the sector, of which 142 have raised



THE COUNTRY'S FLAGSHIP SEMICONDUCTOR CONFERENCE AND EXHIBITION SEMICON INDIA 2026, WILL BE HELD FROM SEPTEMBER 17-19 AT YASHOBHOOMI IN DWARKA, NEW DELHI

equity funding, out of a total of 281 funded companies. The sector recorded \$228 million in funding in 2026 year-to-date (YTD), according to Tracxn.

Tessolve Semiconductor leads the sector in cumulative funding at \$213 million till date, followed by ILJIN Electronics (\$198 million) and VVDN (\$129 million).

Electronic Manufactur-

ing Services has led the sector's funding, securing \$313 million since 2025.

Embedded Hardware ranked second, with \$51.9 million raised since 2025 - entirely within the trailing 12 months - while Power Management Integrated Circuits and Fabless Semiconductor Manufacturers were among the other leading business models by funding.

KEY POINTS

» India is home to 3,557 companies in the sector, of which 142 have raised equity funding, out of a total of 281 funded companies

» The sector recorded \$228 mn in funding in 2026 year-to-date. Electronic Manufacturing Services has led the sector's funding, securing \$313 million since 2025

» The sector's funding rose from \$49 million in 2021 to \$473 million in 2025. The five-year funding compound annual growth rate (CAGR) stood at over 36 per cent

According to the report, the sector's funding rose from \$49 million in 2021 to \$473 million in 2025. The five-year funding compound annual growth rate (CAGR) stood at over 36 per cent.

Bengaluru remained the dominant hub, home to 626 of the sector's 3,557 companies - about 18 per cent of the total - and accounting for 40.1 per

cent of all equity funding raised to date. It was followed by Noida (16.4 per cent), Gurugram (10.7 per cent), Kochi (8.8 per cent) and Hyderabad (6.2 per cent) in terms of funding share.

On exits, the report said acquisitions remained the primary route for Indian semiconductor companies, with the sector recording 62 acquisitions compared with 42 initial public offerings (IPOs). Companies reached acquisition in an average of 11.8 years from their first funding round, against 16.5 years for companies that went public, the report said.

The largest exit on record was eInfochips' \$282 million acquisition, followed by Narayan Powertech (\$262 million) and SmartPlay Technologies (\$180 million), as per the report.

Among recent listings, Tempens Instruments went public in August 2026 with a market capitalisation of \$263 million, while Merritronix listed in June 2026.

FPIs withdraw ₹13,138 crore from Indian equities in September so far

OUR CORRESPONDENT

New Delhi, September 13

Foreign investors pulled out Rs 13,138 crore from Indian equities in the first half of September, as heightened global uncertainty pushed crude oil prices higher, while rising US bond yields and a firm dollar weighed on risk appetite.

The latest outflow comes after Foreign Portfolio Investors (FPIs) turned net buyers in July and August, infusing Rs 20,200 crore and Rs 29,630 crore, respectively, according to data from the Central Depository Services (India) Ltd (CDSL).

Prior to that, FPIs remained net sellers for four consecutive months from March to June.

With the latest withdrawal, the total outflow from Indian equities by FPIs has climbed to Rs 2.37 lakh crore so far in 2026, surpassing the Rs 1.66 lakh crore withdrawn during the entire 2025, the data showed.

According to NSDL data, FPIs withdrew Rs 13,138 crore from Indian equities in the first two weeks of September, till September 11.

Vedant Gupte, Co-



IN THE DEBT MARKET, THEY WITHDREW RS 1,350 CRORE VIA FULLY ACCESSIBLE ROUTE & RS 955 CR THROUGH THE GENERAL ROUTE, WHILE INVESTING RS 29 CR THROUGH VRR

Founder and CEO of investment platform Trackk, said the September selling was driven more by global factors than domestic concerns.

"September selling is a dollar-and-crude story, not an India story. When US yields firm up and oil climbs, money leaves every emerging market," he said.

Brent crude surged to \$109.97 per barrel on Friday and continued to remain above \$102 per barrel, its July-high level, amid heightened geopolitical uncertainty.

Rising bond yields and

a high probability of a rate hike at the US FOMC meeting in the coming week have also weighed on investor sentiment, said Pabitra Mukherjee, Deputy Vice President-Research, Bajaj Broking.

Looking ahead, FPI flows are likely to be significantly influenced by the Iran-US conflict and its consequent impact on crude oil prices.

"Elevated crude prices (Brent is above \$108) and higher inflation imply tighter monetary policy, which means bond yields will rise further," V K Vijayakumar, Chief Investment Strategist at Geojit Investments, said.

"If the US 10-year bond inches up to 5 per cent, there can be a sharp correction in equity markets globally. In such a scenario, FPIs may turn sellers and move money to high-yielding bonds," he added.

Foreign investors also extended their selling to the debt market during the period under review.

They withdrew Rs 1,350 crore through the Fully Accessible Route (FAR) and Rs 955 crore through the general route, while investing Rs 29 crore through the Voluntary Retention Route (VRR).

Gold & silver prices likely to remain volatile next week, say analysts

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA

New Delhi, September 13

Gold and silver prices are likely to remain volatile next week, with the US Federal Reserve's interest rate decision, crude oil movements, the US dollar, and developments in the US-Iran conflict as key drivers of market sentiment, analysts said.

The September 15-16 meeting of the Federal Open Market Committee will be the key global event for bullion markets. The Fed policy and Chair Kevin Warsh's commentary are likely to set the tone for precious metals.

Commodity markets will remain closed for the morning session on Monday due to Ganesh Chaturthi.

The domestic market showed a mixed trend last week, with gold futures for October delivery edging up Rs 17 to Rs 1,52,784 per 10 grams on the Multi Commodity Exchange, while silver fell Rs 2,684, or 1.13 per cent, to settle at Rs 2.34 lakh per kilogram.

The global market, however, remained under pressure, with Comex gold futures for December delivery falling 1.5 per cent to \$4,408.9 per ounce and silver declining 2.34 per cent to \$65.19 per ounce.

'Indians should control lab-grown diamond ecosystem'

AGENCIES

Mumbai, September 13

Union Home Minister Amit Shah on Sunday urged the Indian gems and jewellery industry to control the entire lab-grown diamond ecosystem & build globally dominant brands, saying the market could expand nearly 50-fold in volume.

Addressing the 52nd India Gem & Jewellery Awards in Mumbai, Shah said India had the infrastructure, skills, capital and trading expertise to capture the opportunity.

"In terms of volume, the market for lab-grown diamonds is poised to expand

to nearly 50 times the size of the current diamond market. This represents a huge opportunity," he said.

Shah called for the entire value chain, including manufacturing machinery, diamond production, jewellery making, branding and overseas showrooms, to remain in Indian hands.

The government will introduce a policy for the sector, while Gujarat and Maharashtra are also working on policies, he said.

"India should emerge as a founder member and founder industry in the lab-grown diamond business, while Indian brands should become global brands," he

said. He said India's gems & jewellery exports reached Rs 2.44 lakh crore in 2025, accounting for 6.3 per cent of merchandise exports, while the sector provides direct or indirect jobs to nearly 75 lakh people.

Shah said nine out of 10 diamonds globally are cut, made and designed in Surat, while more than 90 per cent of cut and polished diamonds are processed in India. He also highlighted a 15-year I-T exemption for rough diamond trading companies & businesses in special notified zones, calling it a step towards making India a rough diamond trading hub.

US Fed interest rate decision, inflation data & oil to drive markets in holiday-shortened week

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA

New Delhi, September 13

The US Fed interest rate decision, domestic inflation data, crude oil prices and development in West Asia would be the major drivers for stock market movement in a holiday-shortened week ahead, analysts said.

Equity markets would remain closed on Monday for Ganesh Chaturthi.

"Globally, developments in the US-Iran conflict and movement in Brent crude will remain critical market drivers. This week will be dominated by the US Federal Reserve's monetary policy decision and commentary on the future



path of interest rates," Ajit Mishra, SVP of Research at Religare Broking, said.

On the domestic front, August WPI and CPI inflation data, followed by unemployment and balance of trade data, will remain in focus, he said.

"The immediate focus will be on US inflation and the Federal Reserve's policy decision. The September 11 inflation report showed headline CPI rising 0.4

per cent month-on-month and holding at 3.4 per cent annually, while core inflation increased 0.3 per cent from the previous month but eased to 2.4 per cent year-on-year. The firmer monthly reading keeps inflation risks in focus and could reinforce pressure on global bond yields and the dollar, particularly if the Federal Reserve adopts a more hawkish tone," Harisvelan Radhakrishnan, Founder & CEO of HST Wealth, a Research Analyst firm, said.

The September 15-16 FOMC (Federal Open Market Committee) meeting will therefore be the week's principal global catalyst, he

said. For India, crude oil remains the most immediate external risk, he said, adding that any renewed rise in crude, particularly if disruptions to Middle East oil flows intensify, could add to inflationary pressures, widen the import bill, weigh on the rupee and squeeze corporate margins.

"Domestic data, including WPI inflation and trade figures, will provide additional clues on how much of that pressure is filtering into the economy," Radhakrishnan added. Last week, the BSE benchmark Sensex tumbled 1,733.67 points, or 2.26 per cent, and the NSE Nifty declined 499.6 points, or 2 per cent.

Uttar Pradesh records ₹47,484 crore exports to BRICS members and partner nations

ANI NEWS

New Delhi, September 13

Uttar Pradesh has strengthened its trade engagement with BRICS members and partner nations, recording exports worth Rs 47,484 crore to these markets, as the state steps up efforts to expand the global footprint of its traditional industries, manufacturing units and locally produced goods.

Of the total exports, Rs 34,811 crore were shipped to BRICS members, while exports worth Rs 12,673

OF THE TOTAL EXPORTS, RS 34,811 CR WERE SHIPPED TO BRICS MEMBERS & EXPORTS OF RS 12,673 CR WERE RECORDED WITH PARTNER NATIONS

crore were recorded with partner nations, according to a release.

Under the leadership of Chief Minister Yogi Adityanath, the state is focusing on

attracting industrial investment, improving connectivity, strengthening ease of doing business, generating employment and promoting exports. The government is also working to connect traditional industries and modern industrial units spread across different districts with international markets.

The state has a diversified industrial and agricultural base, with major strengths in agriculture-based industries, food processing, textiles, leather,

electrical equipment, machinery and jewellery, besides other manufacturing segments. The government said that further gains would depend on improving the quality and competitiveness of products while making the export ecosystem more efficient.

"Strengthening quality standards, modern packaging, logistics, testing facilities, branding, and international trade processes will be important for increasing exports," the release said.

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA

New Delhi, September 13

Hyderabad has around 515 Global Capability Centres (GCCs) & 50-70 more will be set up within a year, as the city offers a huge talent pool and cost advantage to foreign firms, according to a FICCI & Anarock report.

Industry body FICCI and property consultant Anarock have come up with a joint report titled 'Hyderabad: The Rise of a Global Capability Powerhouse'. The report highlighted

that there were around 515 GCCs in Hyderabad as of March 2026, employing more than 3 lakh people. Hyderabad accounts for around 20 per cent of the total GCCs in India, transforming the city from a cyber city to the GCC hub.

The report noted that GCCs have become a key demand driver for Hyderabad's office market. The leasing of office space by foreign firms to set up GCCs rose to 4.5 million sq ft in 2025 from 1.9 million sq ft in 2021. In the first half of

this year, the number has crossed 3 million sq ft.

"The sustained leasing momentum reflects the deepening of Hyderabad's GCC ecosystem & the increasing preference of global enterprises to establish larger & more sophisticated operations in the city," Anarock Chairman Anuj Puri said. Hyderabad's GCC proposition is broadening well beyond conventional IT/ITeS functions, said V V Rama Raju, Chairman, FICCI Telangana State Council.

Primary market remains upbeat as 11 IPOs worth ₹24,574 crore line up

Total fundraising comprises five mainboard IPOs worth Rs 24,328.02 cr & six SME issues aggregating Rs 246.26 cr

AGENCIES

New Delhi, September 13

The primary market is set for another busy week, with 11 initial public offerings (IPOs) worth nearly Rs 24,600 crore scheduled to open for subscription despite weakness in the secondary market.

The total fundraising is estimated at Rs 24,574.28 crore, comprising five mainboard IPOs worth Rs 24,328.02 crore and six SME issues aggregating Rs 246.26 crore.

The much-awaited Rs 22,561.6-crore IPO of National Stock Exchange of India (NSE) will open on September 17 and close on September 21. The price band is Rs 1,700-1,785 per share, while the anchor book will open on September 16.

The issue is entirely an offer for sale (OFS) by 10 existing shareholders, including State Bank of India, Canara Pension Plan Investment Board, Aranda Investments, MS Strategic, New India Assurance Com-



pany and SBI Capital Markets. NSE will not receive any proceeds from the offer. The IPO aims to facilitate NSE's listing on BSE.

Hero Motors will be the second-largest mainboard

CLOSER LOOK

» The much-awaited Rs 22,561.6 crore IPO of NSE will open on September 17 & close on September 21. The price band is Rs 1,700-1,785 per share, while e anchor book will open on September 16

» Hero Motors will be the second-largest mainboard issue at Rs 1,000 crore. Its IPO will open on September 16 and close on September 18, with a price band of Rs 79-84

issue at Rs 1,000 crore. Its IPO will open on September 16 and close on September 18, with a price band of Rs 79-84. The issue comprises a fresh issue of Rs 600 crore and an OFS of

Rs 400 crore. SS Retail, Jindal Supreme (India) and Sonaselection India will also launch their IPOs during the week. SS Retail plans to raise Rs 500 crore, Jindal Supreme Rs

124.88 crore and Sonaselection Rs 141.57 crore.

In the SME segment, Vama Wovenfab, Quanto Agroworld and Shakti Polytarp will open their issues on September 15, followed by Kheria Autocomp and SpectraA Technology Solutions on September 17 and Axiom Gas Engineering on September 18.

Meanwhile, the equity market fell more than 2 per cent last week and has corrected nearly 6 per cent from its August high amid concerns over prolonged

Middle East tensions, elevated oil prices and rising US bond yields.

The listing calendar will also remain active, with 19 companies, including 11 from the mainboard segment, scheduled to debut on the bourses next week.

Pranav Constructions will list on September 15, followed by Kanohar Electricals, Prasol Chemicals and Glass Wall Systems (India) on September 16. Rentomojo, Asset Reconstruction Company India, Karamtara Engineering,

LCC Projects, Manipal Payment & Identity Solutions and Steamhouse India are scheduled to list on September 17, while Veegaland Developers is expected to debut on September 18.

In the SME segment, Apana Logistics will list on September 15, followed by Infrax Renewable, Amtech Esters and Vinod Texworld on September 17. Maharaja & Speedex India, Rakshan Transformers, Panchatv Bharat and Om Galaxy are scheduled to debut on September 18.

News at a glance

Kimi Antonelli wins Formula 1 race in Madrid

MADRID: Kimi Antonelli took advantage of Lando Norris' mishaps to win the Spanish Grand Prix in Formula 1's return to Madrid on Sunday, increasing his lead in the drivers' standings. It was the second consecutive victory for Antonelli, the young Mercedes driver who had come-from-behind to win his home race at the Italian GP last weekend. Antonelli was second early on at the new Madring track in the Spanish capital, but pole-sitter Norris relinquished his lead after he wasn't able to pit when a virtual safety car was deployed.

Messi scores his 19th MLS goal as Miami draws with Nashville

MIAMI: Lionel Messi scored his MLS-leading 19th goal of the season as Inter Miami played first-place Nashville to a 2-2 tie. Messi appeared to have Miami on its way to its first win over Nashville this season when he scored with a left-footed shot to make it 2-1 in the 62nd. Nashville's Sam Surridge equalized with his second goal of the night just a minute into stoppage time to keep his club unbeaten in four meetings with Miami this season. Draw also kept Nashville nine points ahead of second-place Miami in Eastern Conference standings.

Arsenal goes clear on top of the Premier League

LONDON: Bruno Guimaraes sent Arsenal three points clear at the top of the Premier League with a moment of brilliance that was doubly painful for Sunderland. Not only did the Brazil midfielder set up a 2-0 win for defending champion Arsenal at the Stadium of Light on Saturday. But, as a former Newcastle player, he made the most of his moment, sending a message to the home supporters who booed him by cupping his ears as he ran towards the corner in celebration.



Dhiraj Bommadevara scripts history, becomes first Indian male recurve archer to win World Cup Final gold

Arshdeep's spell, Abhishek's blitz put India 1-0 up

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
New Delhi, September 13

Arshdeep Singh led India's disciplined bowling effort before Abhishek Sharma produced a blistering 82 as the hosts defeated Afghanistan by seven wickets in the opening T20I at the Feroz Shah Kotla Stadium on Sunday, taking a 1-0 lead in the three-match series.

Arshdeep finished with 3 for 19, sending down 16 dot balls from his 24 deliveries as Afghanistan were restricted to 156 for 8. Jasprit Bumrah also bowled a tight spell, returning 1 for 26 from four overs with 16 dot balls, while Varun Chakravarthi and Axar Patel picked up a wicket each.

Afghanistan were in trouble at 43 for 5 after 10 overs, with their top order unable to handle India's pace and spin. Ibrahim Zadran made 13 and Sediqullah Atal 11 before a mix-up ended the Afghan skipper's stay. Arshdeep then dismissed Atal, while Axar accounted for Gulbadin Naib and Varun breached Darwish Rasooli's defence.

Azmatullah Omarzai and Mohammed Nabi revived the innings with an 83-run sixth-wicket partnership. Omarzai remained unbeaten on 64 off 44 balls, while Nabi made 33 off 27. Arshdeep returned for his second spell to bowl



Nabi after the all-rounder had struck him for a six. Rashid Khan struggled for 10 balls before falling for one, but Omarzai hit Shivam Dube for two sixes in a 21-run final over to take Afghanistan beyond 150.

India's chase was far more straightforward. After Sanju Samson fell for 10, Abhishek and Ishan Kishan added 121 for the second wicket. Kishan made 42 off 33 balls, while Abhishek raced to his 12th T20I fifty in 22 balls.

Abhishek, who had failed to cross 20 in his previous six games, smashed seven sixes and seven boundaries in his 32-ball innings. He was dismissed with India needing only 17 runs, which were completed in 13.4 overs.

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
Dubai, September 13

Shafali Verma and vice-captain Smriti Mandhana struck forceful fifties, while the bowlers under Sree Charani produced an equally intense effort as India crushed Sri Lanka by 72 runs to clinch a record-extending eighth women's Asia Cup title here on Sunday.

Openers Shafali (68) and Mandhana (59) produced a symphony of power and grace during their stand of 129 in just 12.5 overs, guiding India to 183 for five in 20 overs.

The Lankans managed to rein in the opposition's middle-order in the business end of the innings, but they were no match for the guile of Indian bowlers - led ably by left-arm spinner Charani (4/20) - ending up at 111 all out in 20 overs.

Their main, in fact their only hope, was skipper Chamari Athapaththu (36, 32b), who raised 58 runs for the second wicket with Vishmi Gunaratne.

But seasoned off-spinner Deepti Sharma dealt a body blow to Lanka's aspirations, dismissing both batters in the 10th over.

Athapaththu tried to give Deepti the charge but she was beaten in the flight and stumper Richa Ghosh did the rest.

Three balls later, Gunaratne went for a sweep but only to be bowled around



her legs. At 63 for three after 10 overs, with the asking rate soaring over 12, the match was as good as over for the defending champions, and all these despite India shelling five catches.

Earlier, after electing to bat, Mandhana, who hit her 36th T20I fifty, and Shafali, whose 24-ball fifty was the fastest in women's Asia Cup, shut the Lankans out of the match.

In fact, Shafali eclipsed the 25-ball fifty Mandhana made in the tournament's 2022 edition.

The 22-year-old made her intentions clear from the outset, pulling and driving with power.

Shafali targeted Athapaththu in her first over itself, creaming her for 6, 6 and

4 as India reached 57 in the Power Play segment and 98 in at the half-way mark without losing any wicket.

Initially, Mandhana concentrated on giving support to Shafali, reaching 23 off 22 balls. But once her younger partner reached 50, the left-hander shifted the gears easily.

She swept Nilakshi Silva for a six, and then eked out a maximum off Chamudi Praboda, a well-timed strike sailing over long-on.

But her signature shot was an inside out cover drive off Athapaththu for a boundary as Mandhana reached her fifty in 35 balls.

However, the burgeoning stand was snapped when Shafali slapped Praboda straight to Athapaththu at

the edge of the circle.

As it often happens, another wicket followed the first breakthrough. Mandhana was caught in a yes-no situation with skipper Harmanpreet Kaur and eventually sacrificed her wicket via a run out.

It was the third time Mandhana fell victim to run out in this tournament.

India were 140 for two after 15 overs and needed a few more runs to complete the dominance over Lankans, who looked a lot more chirpier after those two wickets.

But in the last five overs India only could manage 43 runs as the big-hitting Richa Ghosh (17, 13b) was dismissed just when she started to accelerate.

BEAT SRI LANKA BY 72 RUNS

India clinch record eighth Women's Asia Cup crown

Hockey: India crowned Asia Cup champions with 4-1 win over Korea

Lift crown for a record sixth time

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
Moqi (China), September 13

India defended their men's Junior Asia Cup title with remarkable ease, winning the final against Korea 4-1 here Sunday to secure a place in the World Cup.

India lifted the continental crown for a record sixth time. India's previous titles came in 2004, 2008, 2015, 2023 and 2024, and the latest triumph further strengthens their position as the most successful team in the history of the tournament.

Ajeet Yadav put India ahead in the 9th minute, scoring through a deflection. Captain Anmol Ekka converted an opportunity in the 13th minute to double India's advantage.

Korea earned a penalty corner in the closing stages of the first quarter, but the Indian defence stood firm to keep the Korean attack at bay. India added their third goal in the 21st minute with Prabhdeep Singh producing a superb finish to send the ball into the net. Korea looked to find a way back

INDIA'S PREVIOUS TITLES CAME IN 2004, 2008, 2015, 2023 AND 2024

into the contest, but India's defensive unit remained compact and disciplined. India went into the half-time break with a commanding 3-0 advantage.

India began the final quarter with the same attacking intent and earned a penalty corner. Korea initially did well to keep out a barrage of attempts on goal, before India were awarded another penalty corner following a referral. Korea's referral was unsuccessful, allowing India to retain the penalty corner.

India made the opportunity count as Ashu Maurya found the back of the net in the 50th minute to extend India's lead to 4-0.

Korea were awarded a penalty stroke following a foul and Captain Lee Minhyeok converted from the spot in the 54th minute to pull one goal back for his side.



PUNCTUATES HER RISE TO NO. 1

Rybakina beats Sabalenka to win US Open title

ASSOCIATED PRESS
New York, September 13

Elena Rybakina came to New York and took everything that had belonged to Aryna Sabalenka.

First, it was the No. 1 ranking in women's tennis, then the U.S. Open trophy. The tournament that for so long was a struggle for Rybakina turned into the site of her coronation.

Rybakina won her first U.S. Open title and punctuated her climb to the top of her sport by beating Sabalenka 6-4, 5-7, 6-2 on Saturday.

Rybakina had already been guaranteed to replace Sabalenka at No. 1 in the rankings next week and for good measure took the title that Sabalenka had won the previous two years.

"It's still so difficult to process what happened," Rybakina said. "Too many achievements these few weeks."

It was the third Grand Slam title for Rybakina and the second this year - both against Sabalenka on hard courts. She opened the season by beating Sabalenka for the Australian Open title.

This time, Rybakina stopped Sabalenka's 19-match winning streak at the U.S. Open, where she hadn't lost since falling to Coco Gauff in the 2023 final.

Rybakina earned \$5.5 million, the largest prize in Grand Slam history, and tied Sabalenka and French Open winner Mirra Andreva with a four-high three titles this season.

Sabalenka falls short of third straight title in New York

Sabalenka took home \$2.8 million but it was clear how little that meant to her, as she smashed her racket after a brief hug with Rybakina at the net.

Sabalenka was trying to become the first person since Serena Williams from 2012-14 to win three in a row at Flushing Meadows.

Rybakina dethroned the champ without even having her best stuff. The WTA Tour leader in aces got less than half of her first serves in but instead put Sabalenka under constant pressure with a strong return game, racking up 12 break chances and converting three, which was all she needed.

The third meeting of No.



1 vs. No. 2 in a U.S. Open women's final since 2000 was the first to go the way of the challenger. Williams was the top seed for the other two, beating her sister Venus in 2002 and Victoria Azarenka in 2013.

The numbers didn't signify much this time, because they are going to flip Monday. Sabalenka has held the top spot for 99 consecutive weeks, but Rybakina gained enough points to unseat her simply by reaching the semifinals.

She didn't stop there. The 27-year-old who was born in Russia but represents Kazakhstan won her first major title at Wimbledon in 2022 and now needs

just the French Open to complete the career Grand Slam.

And it's clear her power - and her ability to absorb her opponent's - was something that unnerved Sabalenka.

"Her serve is amazing, the way she's able to step in and overpower you on court, and especially if it's a U.S. Open court where it's super fast, it's definitely a huge advantage for her," Sabalenka said. "A lot of things make her dangerous."

A native of Belarus, Sabalenka sometimes swings from her heels, like a golfer trying to unleash a 300-yard drive, grunting "Aaaaahhhhh" as she takes

IT WAS THE THIRD GRAND SLAM TITLE FOR RYBAKINA AND THE SECOND THIS YEAR - BOTH AGAINST SABALENKA ON HARD COURTS

her mighty cuts.

Rybakina's power comes more easily. There is little sound coming from her side of the net besides the squeaking of her sneakers, and she rarely shows any hint of stress.

"I think Elena is probably - not nonchalant, I don't want to say that, because she's not nonchalant - but just no reaction ever," Gauff said after losing to Rybakina in the semifinals.

Rybakina did show some frustration after pulling a backhand wide with a break point in the opening game of the third set, but soon she had taken charge of the match for good.

Sabalenka had won the two other meetings this season, on the hard courts at Indian Wells and Miami, and leads their rivalry 10-8.

But her season then took a strange dip after those victories. Sabalenka fell to Naomi Osaka in the fourth round at Wimbledon, then returned to action with consecutive fourth-round exits in Toronto and Cincinnati.

Rybakina has learned to love New York

Rybakina had to take a brief break after she was forced to stop playing in her quarterfinal match against Iga Swiatek in Cincinnati because of a foot injury, but she was healthy in time for a tournament where she had never done particularly well, failing to advance past the fourth round until this year.

"I honestly was coming here for the last 10 years, and it was never successful - nothing close to that," Rybakina said. "It's just incredible. I'm falling in love with New York more and more."

Arthur Ashe Stadium, meanwhile, had been Sabalenka's house, with four straight trips to the final and six to at least the semis. Whatever troubled her during the summer seemed forgotten once she was back in New York - until Saturday.

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr.P.C.

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused Navpreet Singh Banga, R/o: K-146, DLF Capital Greens, 14th Floor, Moti Nagar, New Delhi, Also at: Tower No. 01, 1105, BTPP Park, Sector - 35, Gurugram, Haryana - 122004 has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in Ct. Cases/CC NI Act: 3309/2018, U/s: 138 NI Act, Police Station Kirti Nagar, Delhi and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused Navpreet Singh Banga cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused Navpreet Singh Banga has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused Navpreet Singh Banga of Police Station Kirti Nagar, Delhi is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before 19.11.2026.

By Order
Sh. Gaurav Singal
JMFC (NI Act)-04, West,
Annexe - I, Room No. 04,
Tis Hazari Courts, Delhi

DP/19299/WD/2026

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr.P.C./ 84 Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita, 2023
Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused Mehraj @ Nepali, S/o: Sarfraz, R/o: Yasin Ki Jhuggi, Dhobi Ghat, G Block, Jahangir Puri, Delhi has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case FIR No.: 239/20, U/s: 392/394/506/411/34 IPC, P.S. Jahangir Puri, Delhi and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said Mehraj @ Nepali cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said Mehraj @ Nepali has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused Mehraj @ Nepali of P.S. Jahangir Puri, Delhi is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before 14.10.2026.

By Order
Sh. Sahil Gupta
JMFC-07, North West, Room No. 06,
Rohini Courts, Delhi

DP/12997/NW/2026

ALIA SHARED ABOUT PRODUCING 'DON'T BE SHY'



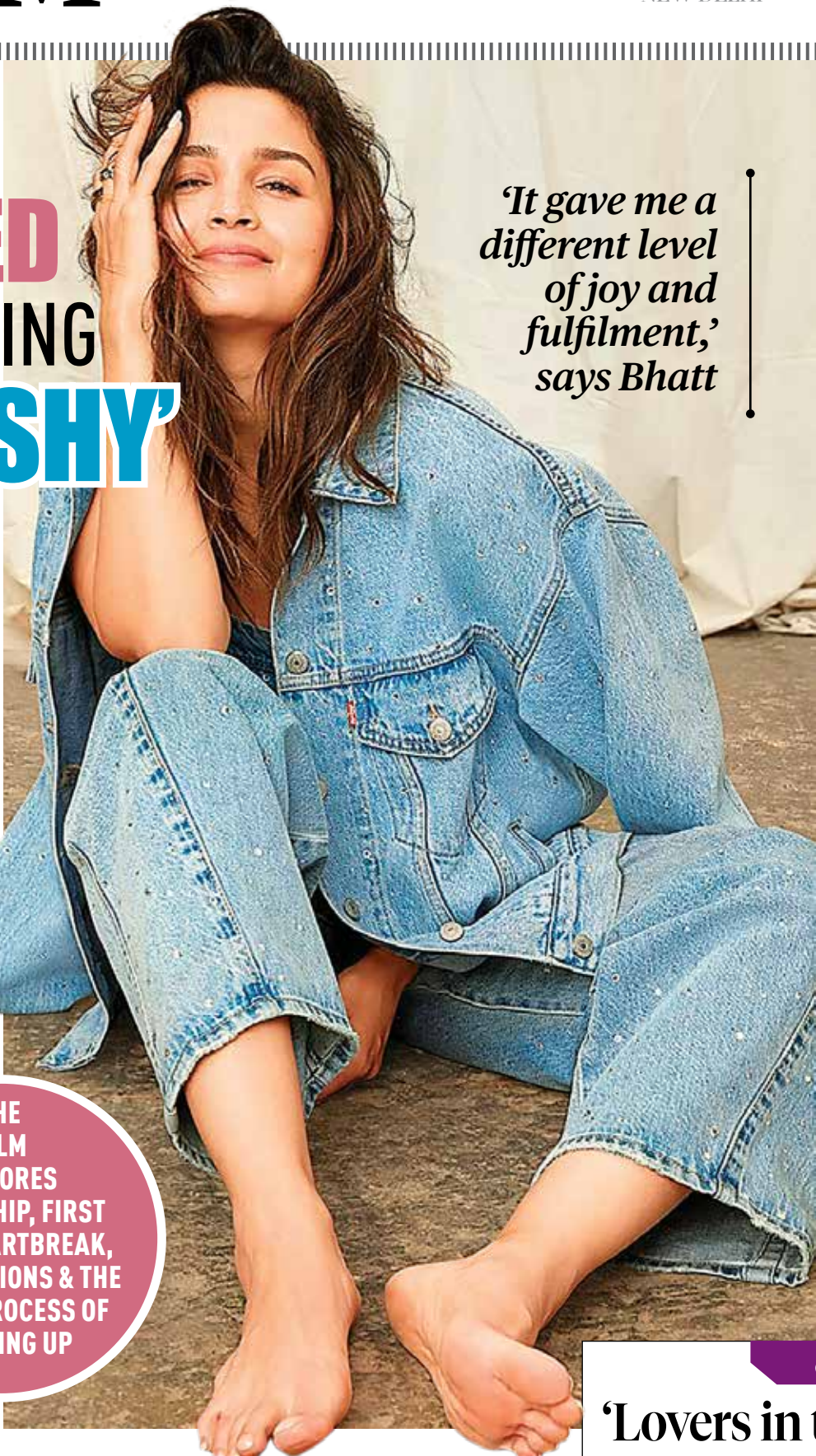
MUMBAI: Actress-producer Alia Bhatt said producing her upcoming young-adult romantic comedy 'Don't Be Shy' has given her a different kind of fulfilment as she got to introduce four newcomers and a debutant director to audiences.

Bhatt, who made her acting debut 14 years ago with Dharma Productions' 'Student of the Year', has produced the movie along with her sister Shaheeh through their banner 'Eternal Sunshine Productions', which they founded in 2021.

The film marks the directorial debut of Sreeti Mukerji, who also wrote the screenplay and introduces four new actors - Aarushi Bajaj, Ansh Duggal, Bianca Arora and Piyush Khatri.

"This is a very big moment for us. 14 years ago, I made my debut as an actor. 14 years later, I am today introducing four new actors and a debutant director. And I'm way more nervous than they are right

THE FILM EXPLORES FRIENDSHIP, FIRST LOVE, HEARTBREAK, BAD DECISIONS & THE MESSY PROCESS OF GROWING UP



'It gave me a different level of joy and fulfilment,' says Bhatt

now," Bhatt told reporters at the trailer launch of the film.

She added, "I really have butterflies in my stomach because I love being an actor and I love being in front of the camera. But it gives me another level of joy because we've been involved in building the world and story from the word go."

'Don't Be Shy' is a coming-of-age romantic comedy centred on Shyamili 'Shy' Das, a 20-year-old who believes she has her life figured out before an unexpected turn throws her plans into disarray. The film explores friendship, first love, heartbreak, bad decisions and the messy process of growing up. PTI

'I experienced the OTT boom with Mirzapur'

MUMBAI: Shriya Pilgaonkar consciously shifted her focus towards films after realising that the industry largely perceives her as an OTT actor and that could possibly influence casting decisions.

She made her Hindi film debut in Shah Rukh Khan-starrer 'Fan' in 2016 and later earned acclaim for her performances in OTT series 'Mirzapur' and 'Broken News'. Her OTT credits also include shows such as 'The Gone Game', 'Taaza

SHRIYA PILGAONKAR SAID SHE CONSCIOUSLY SHIFTED HER FOCUS TOWARDS FILMS

Khabar' and most recently 'Mandala Murders'.

Pilgaonkar said that she chose streaming projects over films that were early in her career as they offered her stronger, performance-driven roles. PTI

'I FELT LIKE A NEWCOMER'

Kareena opened up about working with 'taskmaster' Meghna Gulzar

MUMBAI: Kareena Kapoor Khan said filmmaker Meghna Gulzar's command on the sets of their upcoming film 'Daayra' made her feel like a newcomer despite having spent 26 years in the film industry. The actress stars as a cop alongside actor Prithviraj Sukumaran in Meghna's new movie, which will make its debut in theatres on September 18.

Describing the director as a 'taskmaster', Kareena said Meghna's ability to stay disciplined while remaining warm and kind made her approach the shoot with a sense of responsibility. "She knows how to keep everyone under control. She's loving and kind, but still, on the sets, she has command. I've worked with several directors in my 26-year career, but with Meghna I was always like, 'I have to always be in check'," Kapoor told reporters at a promotional event for the movie.

Kapoor said she would even reach the sets ahead of time to ensure she didn't upset the director. "I'd arrive on set half an hour early because I don't want Meghna to get upset about anything. After 26 years, to have that feeling, I felt like a newcomer," she added. PTI

'SHE KNOWS HOW TO KEEP EVERYONE UNDER CONTROL,' SAYS THE ACTRESS ABOUT THE FILMMAKER



83RD VENICE FILM FESTIVAL

'Lovers in the Blue Night' wins NETPAC Award

OUR CORRESPONDENT Kolkata, September 13

Anuparna Roy's 'Lovers in the Blue Night' won the NETPAC Award for 'Best Asian Film' at the 83rd Venice International Film Festival, where the film competed in the 'Orizzonti' section. The award marks another significant milestone in Anuparna's rapidly emerging international career. The filmmaker made her Venice debut in 2025 with her first feature, 'Songs of Forgotten Trees', for which she won the Orizzonti Award for 'Best Director'. With 'Lovers in the Blue Night', Roy returns to Venice a year later and leaves with her second award at the festival.

The NETPAC jury recognised the film for its sensitive portrayal of marginalised lives in Mumbai, describing it as a 'delicately sensitive vision of the intersecting lives of migrant workers' and praising



PIC/LA BIENNALE DI VENEZIA

Roy's 'confident voice' and the film's 'cohesively nuanced' exploration of displacement, urban survival, hidden desire, gender, poverty and class. The film is in Hindi, Sylheti Bengali and Marathi.

Set against Mumbai's restless underbelly, 'Lovers in the Blue

Night' brings together four lives shaped by migration, loneliness and survival - a closeted husband and his unhappy wife who works in a bar, a lonely man involved in sex work and a petty criminal navigating fleeting desire. Their lives intersect to form an intimate portrait of people living on the margins of a city that never quite allows them to belong.

"Winning the NETPAC Award means a lot to me because this film comes from a very personal place. These are characters and lives that are often pushed to the margins or looked at without really being seen. I wanted to approach them with tenderness, dignity and honesty. To receive this recognition at Venice, a year after my debut was awarded here, is deeply moving. I'm grateful that the film has found space with the audience and jury," said Anuparna, the girl from Bengal's Purulia.

FRACTURED HARMONIES: A CALL FOR RENEWAL

Exploring humanity's relationship with nature

OUR CORRESPONDENT New Delhi, September 13

ReNew, India's leading clean energy and decarbonisation company, partnered with Guru Dr Shovana Narayan, one of India's foremost Kathak exponents, to present 'Fractured Harmonies: A Call for Renewal', a powerful artistic exploration of humanity's relationship with nature and our shared responsibility towards the planet.

Staged at Kamani Auditorium, New Delhi, on September 10, the production wove together classical dance, music and visual storytelling to reflect on pressing environmental challenges, from the degradation of rivers and forests to humanity's expanding footprint beyond Earth. The evening was graced by Stefan Priesner, UN Resident Coordinator in India, as Chief Guest.

This collaboration extends ReNew's commitment to taking the clean energy and climate conversation beyond the energy sector. At the heart of this effort is 'Clean Energy Humse Hai', ReNew's campaign that makes the clean energy transition personal and relevant to every Indian. Built on the idea that clean energy isn't just about technology or policy, but about



THE EVENING WAS GRACED BY STEFAN PRIESNER, UN RESIDENT COORDINATOR IN INDIA, AS CHIEF GUEST

all of us, the campaign seeks to inspire collective ownership of the choices shaping our future.

Conceived by Shovana Narayan, along with her Asavari Repertory, 'Fractured Harmonies' unfolds across four acts, exploring polluted rivers and seas, deforestation and its impact on communities, humanity's growing presence in space and the challenge of space debris. The performance culminates in Restoring Nature's Harmony,

a call to move from recognition to responsibility and from awareness to collective action.

Drawing on the regenerative forces of 'Sooraj', 'hawa' aur 'paani', the production uses the vocabulary of Kathak to reflect on the interconnectedness of life and the possibility of renewal.

Speaking at the occasion, Vaishali Nigam Sinha, Co-founder of ReNew, said: "'Clean Energy Humse Hai' is about recognising that the transition



to a cleaner future is not somebody else's responsibility; it belongs to each of us. Art has a unique ability to make us pause, reflect and feel. Our collaboration with Guru Dr Shovana Narayan brings this message to life in a powerful new way."

"'Fractured Harmonies' reminds us that the choices we make today have consequences for generations to come. But it also reminds us that renewal is possible. We can restore

balance when we recognise our shared responsibility and act together," she added.

Shovana Narayan said, "'Fractured Harmonies' is a subject very close to my heart. Through dance, we have sought to engage with some of the most pressing concerns of our time. While the production acknowledges what is being lost, it also looks towards renewal and our shared capacity to restore balance. Art can encourage us to pause, reflect and perhaps see our responsibilities differently."

Through this initiative, ReNew is broadening the public conversation around India's clean energy transition, encouraging greater individual ownership of the journey towards a sustainable future. By bringing the message into the realm of art and culture, ReNew seeks to make climate action not just something we understand, but something we feel and engage with.

This collaboration reflects a shared belief: addressing the climate challenge requires both systemic change and individual participation. As India moves towards a cleaner energy future, the conversation must reach beyond the energy sector and become part of the larger national dialogue on how we live, consume and coexist with our natural world.

CONCEIVED BY GURU DR SHOVARA NARAYAN, IT WAS STAGED AT KAMANI AUDITORIUM ON SEPTEMBER 10

